

EFRAM GELLER
2023



MISTER IRRELEVANT'S
NFL DRAFT
GUIDE

2023 Draft Guide

Last year was the largest draft project I've attempted, and this year I was even more ambitious. There are 112 profiles below and nearly 150 pages of nonstop draft content.

More players will be added and updated as the cycle continues. My profiles include measurements, athletic testing, strengths and weaknesses with an overall draft grade. Quarterbacks were given pro comparisons that best fit their playstyle. Not only is each prospect's film fully broken down, but I include their projected role and production in the NFL. With strengths and weaknesses, some players received a + to indicate that they are especially elite at a trait. (You may find a few ++ icons)

Hopefully this year you'll find the guide much easier to navigate. I sorted the prospects by position and added hotlinks that will take you straight to your favorite players.

Thanks for reading once again, and all my draft content can be found on my twitter ([@MrIrrelevant](#)) and my [Substack Page](#).

Enjoy the guide. -Mister Irrelevant

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RAS NOTE: RAS scores were used to quantify athleticism for most of the prospects. RAS is a tool created by Kent Lee Platte (@MathBomb) that takes all the measurables and testing at the combine, compares it to every other player at the position and scores them out of 10. For example, a player who is in the top 70% testing of all time at his position receives a 7.0 RAS.

RAS RELATIVE ATHLETIC SCORE 2023 NFL COMBINE					
LUKAS VAN NESS DE IOWA 2023					
HAND SIZE	11	RAS < 9.75u >	ARM LENGTH	34	
COMPOSITE SIZE GRADE : GREAT			COMPOSITE SPEED GRADE : ELITE		
HEIGHT	8050	8.80	40 YD DASH	4.58	9.80
WEIGHT	272	7.80	20 YD SPLIT	2.86u	9.82
BENCH			10 YD SPLIT	1.64	8.30
COMPOSITE EXPLOSION GRADE : GOOD			COMPOSITE AGILITY GRADE : GREAT		
VERTICAL	31	4.28	SHUTTLE	4.32	8.34
BROAD	910	7.77	3-CONE	7.02	8.88
ATHLETIC TESTING ON A SCALE OF 0 TO 10					

Table Of Contents

2023 Draft Guide.....	2
Table Of Contents.....	2
Top 100 Rankings.....	4
Quarterbacks.....	5
Running Backs.....	15
Wide Receivers.....	23
Tight Ends.....	42
Offensive Tackles.....	50
Interior Offensive Line.....	62
Edge Rushers.....	70
Defensive Line.....	90
Linebacker.....	102
Cornerbacks.....	112
Safety.....	129
Acknowledgments:.....	137
Contact Info.....	137

Top 100 Rankings

(Press to go directly to the prospect)

1. Will Anderson 2. Jalen Carter 3. Bryce Young 4. Paris Johnson Jr. 5. Christian Gonzalez
6. Bryan Bresee 7. C.J. Stroud 8. Devon Witherspoon 9. Tyree Wilson 10. Anthony Richardson
11. Lukas Van Ness 12. Peter Skoronski 13. Joey Porter Jr. 14. Will Levis 15. Myles Murphy 16. Nolan Smith
17. Jordan Addison 18. Bijan Robinson 19. Jaxon Smith-Njigba 20. Anton Harrison 21. Quentin Johnston
22. Cam Smith 23. Brian Branch 24. Jaylon Jones 25. Dawand Jones 26. Kelee Ringo
27. Jahmyr Gibbs 28. Darnell Washington 29. Broderick Jones 30. Michael Mayer 31. Jack Campbell
32. Adetomiwa Adebawore 33. Tuli Tuipulotu 34. Calijah Kancey 35. JL Skinner 36. Keanu Benton
37. Felix Anudike-Uzomah 38. Joe Tippmann 39. Emmanuel Forbes 40. DJ Turner 41. Drew Sanders
42. Jalin Hyatt 43. Deonte Banks 44. Isaiah Foskey 45. Blake Freeland 46. Mazi Smith
48. John Michael Schmitz 49. Trenton Simpson 50. Christopher Smith 51. Luke Musgrave
52. Xavier Hutchinson 53. BJ Ojulari 54. O'Cyrus Torrence 55. Cody Mauch 56. DeMarvion Overshown
57. Julius Brents 58. Darnell Wright 59. Andrew Vorhees 60. Sydney Brown 61. Siaki Ika
62. Josh Downs 63. Devon Achane 64. Michael Wilson 65. Dalton Kincaid 66. A.T. Perry 67. Zay Flowers
68. Clark Phillips 69. Zach Charbonnet 70. Kyu Blu Kelly 71. Zach Harrison 72. Antonio Johnson
73. Jordan Battle 74. Luke Wypler 75. Tyjae Spears 76. Moro Ojomo 77. Wanya Morris
78. Matthew Bergeron 79. Will McDonald IV 80. Keion White 81. Jaelyn Duncan 82. Tucker Kraft
83. Nick Herbig 84. Andre Carter 85. Zacch Pickens 86. Jaquelin Roy 87. Dylan Horton 88. Marvin Mims
89. Tyler Scott 90. Steve Avila 91. Eli Ricks 92. Tre'Vius Hodges-Tomlinson 93. Trey Palmer
94. Jammie Robinson 95. Daiyan Henley 96. Rashee Rice 97. Cedric Tillman 98. Tyrique Stevenson
99. Garrett Williams 100. Dorian Williams 101. Mike Morris 102. Tank Bigsby 103. Gervon Dexter
104. Andrei Iosivas 105. Roschon Johnson 106. Derick Hall 107. Nick Hampton 108. Kayshon Boutte
109. Ji'Ayir Brown 110. Noah Sewell 111. Isaiah McGuire 112. Owen Pappoe

Quarterbacks



Quarterbacks are the pinnacle of the NFL Draft and should be treated as such. This year I completely revamped my Quarterback presentation and broke down the scouting notes into five major categories. I wanted to take a closer look at the key attributes that make up the hottest prospects in the draft. My principle when drafting Quarterbacks is vastly different than the other positions. As a first round prospect, especially in the top twenty, I think you must have a possible route to becoming a franchise Quarterback. This means that NFL teams drafting one must be prepared (and hope) to pay your QB a second contract, which is far from cheap. So the prospect you're looking at must have a ceiling that justifies a top contract in the NFL. This is why I've been noticeably lower on prospects like Mac Jones, who in my opinion lacks the ceiling to earn that major contract. More than any other position, young Quarterbacks rely heavily on their situation. Offensive coaching, weapons and an offensive line can make or break most careers, and is especially important for this year's group. It's difficult to project Quarterbacks before they land with a team, but I tried to break down how each prospect would fit with a range of supporting casts.

1. Bryce Young (#3)

Alabama – (5'10" 204 lbs)

Size/Athleticism:

Size is the obvious issue with Bryce Young. No quarterback has ever played at his size, and while he weighed in at 204 lbs, he'll likely play at a lower weight. Young may have trouble taking hits and playing through contact. He has quick feet and scrambling instincts, but isn't a massive running threat. With Young's frame, teams are taking a risk on a lengthy and healthy career.

Arm Talent/Strength:

A largely overlooked aspect of Young's profile is his arm talent. He lacks elite arm talent and doesn't have the velocity or deep ball of the top NFL QB's. Young is strong enough to excel at intermediate and short throws. He can throw deep but it isn't his strong suit.

Pocket Presence/Maneuverability:

Bryce Young has elite+ pocket presence. He seemingly has eyes in the back of his head and extends plays while looking downfield. Young weaves between lineman and is extremely elusive to catch.

Progressions/QB IQ:

Young is a smart player who doesn't force many passes. He can break down a defense and find the open route. Young can overanalyze plays and extend them for too long – but this should be coached out early. He's great with progressions and has the complete mental package that you rarely see in a prospect. Young has the intangibles and intelligence to start day one.

Accuracy:

His accuracy varied between games, but was relatively solid overall. Young has elite quick accuracy on short throws and dump offs. He can miss some intermediate throws, but was mostly fine. His deep ball is the most inconsistent of his passes, with

Table Of Contents

him missing some and pinpointing others. Bryce displayed elite ball placement against Utah State and Arkansas, but wasn't as productive in his other games. He may not be an elite accuracy thrower, but has quality accuracy especially for a rookie.

Overall:

I'm not quite as high on Bryce Young due to his frame and arm talent, but agree that he possesses uncoachable skills. His recent comparisons to a "smaller Patrick Mahomes" are a bit crazy given Young has nowhere near Mahomes' arm talent. Bryce is pro ready, with the progressions skills and high floor passing to succeed early on. His maneuverability sets him apart from the other prospects and will help him navigate poor offensive lines. Bryce lacks elite arm talent or velocity and won't be amongst the NFL's top field stretchers. I don't think his ceiling is as high as people think as he doesn't have many elite explosive traits. He can be a pro bowler if he can overcome the questions on his build. Drafting Young brings more risk than usual for a QB of his skillset, as no quarterback has succeeded at his size. He'll be a capable starter early on and should be able to manage a team's offense. Young had a phenomenal college career and carried Alabama's offense this season.

Strengths:

Improvisation/Pocket Instincts+
College Career
Quick Game
Football IQ
Passing Under Pressure

Weaknesses:

Size/Frame
Elite Arm Talent/Velocity
Deep Ball
Can Hold Onto Ball For Too Long

Pro Comparison: Drew Brees (Is a shorter QB without elite arm talent, but is extremely cerebral and accurate, and is a proven winner)

Grade: Top Ten

2. C.J. Stroud (#7)

Ohio St. – (6'3" 214 lbs)

Size/Athleticism:

Stroud has prototype size at 6'3" 214 lbs. He has no frame issues and should be able to withstand some hits. He has solid athleticism and has the ability to run but barely does. He can brush off some rushers but isn't a threat with the ball.

Arm Talent/Strength:

He doesn't have a rocket arm, but can hit throws practically anywhere on the field. Stroud isn't in the elite tier of arm talent, but has no issues and can throw deep. He prefers the moon ball over rocket passes. His velocity is solid, but not top tier. There's nothing to rave about, but everything is up to par and is overall pretty good. Besides a slight dip, his release is pretty and could maybe speed up a little.

Pocket Presence/Maneuverability:

Stroud doesn't look to run often and prefers to stay in the pocket. He was a playmaker against Georgia, but in the rest of his games he got rid of the ball when he faced pressure. Stroud isn't a natural play extender and is indecisive as a runner. He's mostly worse when pressured and on the run, with his throws being rushed and his accuracy declining.

Progressions/QB IQ:

Most of his reads were fairly simple with open elite receivers. He makes the right reads and only forced throws when pressured or on the run. Stroud was clutch against Georgia, which was the most adversity he faced all season. He doesn't show much "it" factor or natural instincts in the other games, but did everything that was asked of him. Stroud can go through progressions smoothly.

Accuracy:

With a clean pocket and set feet, Stroud throws with pinpoint accuracy and ball placement. His best skill is pocket passing and he hits receivers in stride while rarely missing throws. He isn't crazy nuanced as a passer with unique angles and throws, and

Table Of Contents

prefers casual accuracy. Stroud had mostly perfect conditions when throwing and had plenty of time in the pocket, which will likely not happen in the NFL.

Overall:

Stroud's profile both benefits and suffers from being Ohio State's quarterback. He did everything asked of him, but was rarely put in tough situations. Stroud threw to four first rounders the past two years, and was protected by two first round tackles. It's harder to project Stroud on a bad NFL team, as the supporting cast will likely be worse. He has perfect pocket pass skills and will have a full playbook. If Stroud is drafted to a team with a solid supporting cast he can step in right away and deliver. He may struggle to carry a poor team with playmaking and play extending.

Stroud stepped up against Georgia and gave a glimpse of his ceiling if he can unlock playmaking skills. On a good team Stroud can be a top 10/15 consistent quarterback as a fair projection to succeed with a high floor, but won't be a top tier QB. Stroud has a higher floor than Richardson and Levis, but lacks their ceiling. He should be in the league for a while and can be in the Dak/Kirk/Matt Ryan pro bowl tier of quarterbacks.

Strengths:

Accuracy+

Ball Placement

Consistency

Touch and Anticipation

Weaknesses:

Playmaking

Great Team with Relatively Easy Role

Can Struggle Under Pressure

Pro Comparison: Jared Goff (Does everything asked of him and has good accuracy, and can struggle without a supporting cast and time in the pocket. Stroud is more athletic than Goff)

Grade: Top Twelve

3. Anthony Richardson (#10)

Florida – (6'4" 244 lbs)

Size/Athleticism:

The obvious selling point for Anthony Richardson is his game breaking athleticism. Richardson has the size to play tight end and is a one of a kind dual threat. Richardson was the greatest combine tester ever at the position, posting a perfect 10 RAS. All of his numbers were ridiculous, with a 4.43 forty (99%), a 40.5" vert (100%) and a 10'9 broad jump (100%). What's crazy is that he would've recorded the same 10 RAS as a receiver and tested better than practically any pass catcher this year. He's a dangerous runner that is big enough to break tackles and fast enough to breakaway from the defense. He'll rely on his A+ athleticism and running early on to make plays

Arm Talent/Strength:

Richardson has elite arm talent to effortlessly launch throws deep. He has the velocity to hit tight windows. His potential as a passer is sky high and Richardson has a ceiling similar to Josh Allen. His throwing motion needs fixing and there may be arm strength that Richardson left untapped. There's no possible throw on a playbook that Richardson won't be able to hit.

Pocket Presence/Maneuverability:

While Richardson is a clear developmental quarterback, his pocket presence is better than expected. Richardson maneuvers while behind the line and avoids rushers with his athletic traits. His footwork is far from refined, but he has untouchable traits in the pocket. Richardson can take off too much and scramble instead of looking downfield.

Progressions/QB IQ:

Richardson is semi-inconsistent with his progression skills. He showed the ability to go through progressions and make reads, but has plays where he stares down receivers and misses routes. Richardson only has 455 career dropbacks and is still learning the nuances of the game. He's still very young and should only improve his QB instincts as he gains experience. He can read defenses quite well for his experience and can occasionally break down zones and find holes.

Accuracy:

Accuracy is easily the weakest part of Richardson's game. 28.2% of his throws the last two seasons were uncatchable which ranks seventh last in the country. His mechanics are all over the place and will hopefully be fixed by a QB coach. Richardson misfires some throws and can completely miss his receivers. When Richardson gets in a rhythm he can hit consistently for a few drives, but is far from being a ready, accurate thrower. He'll need to vastly improve his accuracy to be a successful starter. He also needs to develop more anticipation, but this should come with time. Richardson is as inaccurate as a first round prospect can get, and limits any chance of him succeeding as a passer early on.

Overall:

Anthony Richardson is the classic traitsy QB prospect. He may be the most athletic quarterback in NFL history and will rely on his legs early on. His rocket arm gives him the potential to be one of the best dual threat quarterbacks in the league. He only has fifteen career starts and is still learning the position, but his mental QB skills are better than expected and should develop quickly. The big issue with Richardson is his accuracy and there's no chance for him if he can't improve as a pure thrower. He needs a complete mechanical rehaul to function as a starter. If Richardson's accuracy is fixed he'll be an extremely explosive starter, but it may be the reason he busts. He has both the highest ceiling and lowest floor of any of the top quarterback prospects. Richardson shouldn't start as a rookie and is best in a scheme that utilizes his legs to get open throws. Richardson is quite the risky bet, but his high end quarterback traits are too much to pass on.

Strengths:

Athleticism/Size++

Rare Rocket Arm

Playmaker Potential

Weaknesses:

Accuracy

Consistency

Throwing Mechanics

Pro Comparison: Josh Allen (There are virtually no quarterbacks who can match Richardson's athletic profile, so it was tough to find a comparison. Josh Allen is the closest as an extremely athletic QB with elite physical traits, while being wildly inaccurate in college. Both have solid mental quarterback traits given their lack of experience and refinement)

Grade: Top Fifteen

✚. Will Levis (#14)

Kentucky – (6'4" 230 lbs)

Size/Athleticism:

Will Levis has prototype size at 6'4" 230 lbs. He isn't an extremely dangerous dual threat, but is athletic enough to be mobile in the pocket and occasionally take off. Levis runs with power more than speed, and is capable of breaking NFL tackles. He is large enough to withstand hits, but dealt with injuries this past season.

Arm Talent/Strength:

Levis is an effortless thrower with elite velocity in intermediate and short passes. He can fit throws into tight windows and can add touch on deep balls. Levis can make every throw an NFL should be able to hit, which allows OC's to call in deep shots if he can hone in his accuracy. Levis doesn't have the A+ arm of Herbert, Allen and Mahomes, and is closer to A-/B+ arm talent. The arm talent potential is clearly there if Levis can work on his accuracy.

Pocket Presence/Maneuverability:

It may be a result of Kentucky's horrible offensive line, but Levis showcased poor pocket presence this season. There were many plays where Levis dropped back 5+ yards in the pocket before throwing off his back foot. He needs to step up in the pocket and maneuver his way around his lineman instead of retreating. Levis was pressured a ton and dealt with blind side sacks often. He'll likely get drafted to a team with a bad line, so the habits he picked up at Kentucky may be exploited early.

Progressions/QB IQ:

Table Of Contents

Levis ran a Shanahan style offense at Kentucky and can make the necessary calls and line checks. He stacks up well with the other QB's in terms of breaking down defensive zones and schemes. Levis is overconfident in his arm and believes he can make every throw. The talent is there, but Levis attempts tough throws that he regrets. Levis can lock onto routes he likes and trusts his arm to make it anyways, while missing open receivers altogether. His decision making is Levis' Achilles heel, which is only boosted by his confidence as a passer. Levis threw twenty three interceptions in the past two seasons and is clearly prone to turnovers.

Accuracy:

Levis' accuracy is inconsistent and is the biggest factor holding back his arm talent. He has throws (especially deep) where he layers the ball perfectly into the receiver's arms, then will throw the ball into the dirt the next play. Levis' bigger concern is ball placement, oftentimes placing the ball behind or above the receiver, forcing them to contort to make the catch. Levis' accuracy isn't a glaring hole in his game, but his ball placement will need to improve to develop into a top tier quarterback.

Overall:

Levis' film this season was a step down from 2021. He lost his weapons this year and his offensive line constantly let him down. Levis has the talent and traits to be an upper echelon Quarterback, but needs to be a smarter player. His pocket presence must be fixed immediately or he'll get abused his rookie year. You're betting that Levis' play this season was a result of his supporting cast and nagging injuries, and that the poor habits he developed this year won't stick. He should play in an easy read system (1,2,3 ball out), where he can focus on his ball placement until he refines his progression skills. Levis is a day one starter that will have plenty of mistakes and turnovers early on. He can be a top ten quarterback, but has a tendency to turn the ball over.

Strengths:

Arm Talent

Size

Deep Balls

Table Of Contents

Weaknesses:

Pocket Presence

Overconfidence in Arm

Field Vision

Pro Comparison: Carson Wentz (NFL size with athleticism and arm talent. QB IQ needs to improve along with turnovers and pocket presence)

Grade: Top Fifteen

Running Backs



Running Back is the NFL's forgotten position in the draft, with first round selections getting increasingly rarer. Running Backs are far from a premium with most of them relying on their scheme and offensive line to succeed. Teams with a proper foundation are able to plug Running Backs in at will, while many talented Running Backs have failed to produce behind below average offensive lines. Top prospects must be much noticeably better than their replacement and ascend a team's scheme and roster.

Juice is an important aspect when scouting Running Backs and is a relatively clear indication of early success. I value athletic testing for RB's highly and traits are very translatable for pure running. It's important for college RB's to run downhill instead of attempting a plethora of unnecessary skill moves behind the line. Pass protection is an undervalued trait that allows rookie Running Backs to earn snaps and

stay on the field. To me, in order to be a first or early second round prospect, a player must be tough to replace as a runner while also boosting their team's passing game. This year's class has two prospects who fit that role (you'll find out soon enough), and a few other prospects who will be explosive in the right scheme.

1. Bijan Robinson (#18)

Texas – (5'11" 215 lbs)

Bijan Robinson has been heralded as the best running back prospect of the last decade. I don't think he's a fully finished product, but Bijan is indeed the best running back I've scouted so far. Bijan was nearly unstoppable at Texas, recording 1,575 rushing yards and 18 touchdowns. Even with a bigger build, Bijan is the shiftest ball carrier in the class and combines elusiveness and strength to break tackles at will. His 104 forced missed tackles this season led all of college football (also the most in the last 10 years). Bijan's career 39% missed tackle rate is the second highest for any running back in the last eight seasons. He isn't purely an athlete and he is a smart runner that reads holes well and bounces outside. His field vision is spectacular and can run in both power and zone schemes well. Bijan is dangerous in the open field and has a little bit of every skill when running. He managed to put up elite performances with a subpar offensive line.

Many great running back prospects, including Saquon Barkley, have suffered from "superman syndrome" and Bijan can sometimes find himself fitting into that category. He can be over patient at times and try to do too much. Bijan can go for the home run threat and overlook the consistent four and five yard runs. He can get distracted by lateral tackle breaking instead of strictly running downhill. Besides that, the biggest limiting factor on Bijan's stock is his positional value at running back. While ten years ago a player with Bijan's skill set would be a top five lock, Bijan may not be selected until the end of the first round. However, Bijan's receiving ability should not be overlooked and should raise his value completely. Bijan is a tremendous three down threat. who can both block and catch passes 15+ yards out of the backfield. He's a capable route runner that can line up out wide. Bijan has the talent to be a top fifty pick purely of his receiving talent. Bijan can step in right away as both an alpha running back and a quarterback's best friend in the passing game.

Strengths:

Shifty++

Table Of Contents

Build

Complete Versatile Skillset

Field Vision/Following Blockers

Balance

Weaknesses:

Can Be Too Patient At Times

Occasional Superman Syndrome

Grade: Top Twenty

2. Jahmyr Gibbs (#27)

Alabama – (5'9" 199 lbs)

Jahmyr Gibbs carried Alabama's skill positions this season in both the run and passing game. He's a smaller back at right under 200 pounds, but is a violent downhill runner that is capable of breaking tackles. Gibbs has fantastic vision and follows his blockers to create holes. He's shifty and makes defenders miss with electric footwork. Gibbs has the full arsenal of ball carrier moves and uses jukes as his primary attack. As dynamic as Gibbs is as a rusher, he brings tremendous value as a pass catcher. He led the nation the last three years with 25 catches of over 15 yards. Gibbs can be a legitimate high target threat out of the backfield and will rack up YAC plays. His size is a concern and it'll be harder for him to break NFL tackles. His pass protection is weak and will limit his snaps. Gibbs is a perfect modern day fit, with a versatile inside/outside running and receiving value. He can handle a full workload early on and receive double digit targets as well. He'll be a productive back immediately and should establish himself as one of the NFL's most dangerous dual threats. The skill gap between Bijan and Gibbs isn't very far, and is much closer than Gibbs and the rest of the running back class.

Strengths:

Elusive+

Explosive Through Gaps

Versatile Runner

Receiving Threat

Weaknesses:

Size

Pass Protection

Grade: Late First/Early Second

3. Devon Achane (#63)

Texas A&M – (5'8" 188 lbs)

With teams valuing speed above all at the running back position, Devon Achane takes the mantle of the fastest player in the class. He ran a 4.32 forty yard dash and recorded a 10.10 100-meter dash time. Achane isn't purely a speed threat and is a threatening runner. He's small with a low center of gravity that creates lightning jukes and spins. He's a true home run threat who changes directions at will. Achane reads gaps well before exploding through them. He torched defenses with his vision and burst, which is impressive considering he played behind an atrocious Texas A&M offensive line. There were many times that Achane was forced to create plays out of nothing, as his offensive line let him down on numerous plays.

Achane was rarely used as a pass catcher and is practically unproven at that role, but has the traits to be a potential receiving threat. Achane's role is obviously limited by his size, as 5'8" 188 lbs isn't going to cut it as a bell cow back. He struggles to pass block with his frame and will get taken out of the game in some obvious passing downs. With Achane's muscle mass he isn't a tackle breaker and won't fit on any team looking for a power back. Achane is an outside zone running fit who will fill the speed role for a team. If Achane lands with a zone scheme like Shanahan's 49ers or McDaniels' Dolphins he'll be a force to be reckoned with. Playcallers that utilize speed will fight for the chance to draft Achane. He isn't a complete every down running back, but Devon Achane is the perfect explosive addition.

Strengths:

Shifty

Vision/Using Gaps

Big Play Threat

Weaknesses:

Size

Power Running/Tackle Breaking

Pass Protection

Unproven Pass Catcher

Grade: Early Third

✚ Zach Charbonnet (#69)

UCLA – (6'0" 214 lbs)

Formerly a Michigan commit, Zach Charbonnet transferred to UCLA and produced two outstanding years of stellar play. He's a power back that has translatable size at 6'0" 214 lbs. He uses his size well to break tackles and gain extra yards. His 122 missed tackles forced over the last two years ranks third in the nation. Charbonnet runs with a low pad level and is creative through gaps. He doesn't have game changing speed or juice, but makes defenders miss in open space. Charbonnet deploys a multiplicity of moves, and knows when to use spins, jukes and deadlegs. He isn't a special receiver but can catch passes out of the backfield. Charbonnet lacks the explosive juice to be a true RB1, but is an easy projection to be a productive back. He averaged around 20 carries a game at UCLA and should be able to carry a heavy workload in the NFL. His combine was solid all around, with jumps of 37" (86%) and 10'2" (82%). Charbonnet will be a productive power back that will play a heavy role in a zone run committee and contribute immediately.

Strengths:

College Production

Tackle Breaking

Running Consistency

Can Handle Heavy Workload

Weaknesses:

Elite Juice/Breakaway Speed

Pass Catching Threat

Already Has a Lot of Carries

Grade: Early/Mid Third

5. Tyjae Spears (#75)

Tulane – (5'9" 201 lbs)

Tyjae Spears is one of the most explosive playmakers in the 2023 NFL draft. He's a smaller running back that is insanely creative with the ball in his hands. Spears ran for 1,500 yards and 19 touchdowns, with 1,000 of those yards coming after contact (5th in CFB). He bursts off the line and bounces outside to create open space. Tyjae Spears is a unique runner that pulls off creative jukes and spins that other running backs wouldn't even think of. He explodes through holes and is a home run threat with loads of juice. He torched USC with numerous highlight worthy runs. Spears isn't a power runner and isn't tough to bring down, but he can break leg tackles and getting your hands on him is difficult given his dynamic direction changes. Spears destroyed Senior Bowl week, putting defenders on skates and obliterating linebackers in 1v1 drills. He isn't a pass catching back, but has the traits to be a YAC receiver.

Most of his issues aren't skill related and stem from either his injury history or size. He tore his ACL and meniscus in 2020, both injuries that are especially challenging for running backs. Spears barely breaks the 200 pound threshold, and lacks the size to be a bell cow back. It's difficult to bet on a long career for Spears with his frame, and it's reasonable to question how long his elite explosiveness will last. His pass protection isn't very good and can limit his snaps in the backfield. Spears can be an amazing committee back as a true running threat that scares defenses.

Strengths:

Burst/Explosion

Home Run Threat

Shifty/Body Control

Run Creativity

Senior Bowl Performance

Weaknesses:

Limited As a Pass Catcher

Table Of Contents

Pass Protection

Not a Power Back

Size/Bellow Ability

Grade: Early/Mid Third

6. Tank Bigsby (#102)

Iowa – (5'11" 210 lbs)

Tank Bigsby is a productive college running back who is a safe bet to be an important committee back. Bigsby is an intelligent runner who uses his vision to find holes. He wins with his shifty cuts and zone running skills. Bigsby doesn't have many elite traits, but is a solidly well rounded runner. He accelerates well and changes his speed while running, but lacks elite home run speed. Bigsby can make defenders miss, but isn't a power runner and will have trouble breaking NFL tackles. He isn't very sudden, but can bounce runs outside. Bigsby is a simple evaluation as a player who may not stand out, but is an easy fit for a zone scheme. His ability to read his blockers and cut into holes is valuable and will establish his role.

Strengths:

Vision

Bouncing Runs

Acceleration

Cutbacks

Weaknesses:

Lacks Elite Traits

Breaking NFL Tackles

Grade: Early Fourth

7. Roschon Johnson (#105)

Syracuse – (6'0" 219 lbs)

Table Of Contents

Roschon Johnson is heavily overshadowed by his teammate Bijan Robinson and is an underrated prospect with impressive value. In a class of smaller RB's, Roschon stands out as a bigger back with a power profile. He is a tough runner who can break tackles in short yardage situations and churn out extra yards. Roschon has impressive balance and can withstand powerful hits and stay on his feet. He is patient with the vision to find holes in the backfield. Roschon doesn't have much of a speed profile and isn't a dangerous open field runner that will threaten defenses deep. He is a pure downhill runner that lacks the lateral agility to be creative side-to-side.

The decision to stay at Texas as Bijan's backup says a lot about Roschon's character. He could've had a larger role someplace else, but chose to stay and did everything Texas asked of him. Roschon is the best pass protector in the class, which should secure him NFL snaps. He can protect the quarterback and give the featured running back a physical break. Roschon had a fantastic Senior Bowl, winning on routes, runs and pass blocking reps. Coaches will fall in love with Roschon's blocking and work ethic. He profiles as a power back who will be productive in short yardage situations.

Strengths:

Senior Bowl
Pass Protection
Breaks Tackles
Gains Extra Yards

Weaknesses:

Lateral Agility
Homerun Speed

Grade: Fourth

Wide Receivers



The key to succeed as a Wide Receiver prospect is having a way to win/a skill or trait that you can rely on. The caveat is that not only must the receiver be able to use it against NFL Cornerbacks, it must be a trait that is already proven to garner separation on all three levels. Skills like contested catches and vertical speed are valued aspects in their own right, but can't carry a receiving profile. With athleticism, juice and fluidity in routes are extremely necessary for a receiver to separate. This is a small receiver class and many of these prospects will play in the slot. The NFL is a grown man's league and physicality is a reasonable issue for a lot of these prospects. Bigger prospects like Quentin Johnston, A.T. Perry and Michael Wilson are boosted by their availability on the outside. This is an underwhelming class, so I expect teams to take chances on the high ceiling receivers.

1. Jordan Addison (#17)

USC – (5'11" 171 lbs)

Table Of Contents

Following a tremendous season at Pittsburgh, Jordan Addison was one of the biggest names in the transfer portal. Playing alongside Heisman winner Caleb Williams, Addison may not have replicated his 2021 season, but established himself as one of the nation's top receivers. Addison wins on all three levels with route running and suddenness. He can line up anywhere and has soft, reliable hands. He's a pure separator in man, and has the instincts to win against zone coverage. His instincts and nuance while running routes is the best in the class. Addison isn't a burner, but has the ball skills to win deep and stretch the field. He'll run a full route tree in the NFL.

Addison's biggest concerns stem from his slender frame. He has limited play strength and can get pushed to the sideline. His strength also affects his contested catch ability (22.2% Contested Catch Rate). While Addison can deliver some YAC, he lacks the strength to be a tackle breaker. His release isn't a concern, but can be improved. Addison excels on middle of the field routes, as it's easier to use route running to avoid contact.

Jordan Addison wasn't expected to blow up the Combine, but he measured out smaller than most hoped while not testing particularly well. His numbers were particularly average (5.81 RAS), but disappointing for someone with his frame concerns. If Addison was closer to 200 lbs and 6'0/6'1 he'd be the top receiver in the draft. His film drew comparison to Stefon Diggs, but Diggs tested similarly at 6'0 195. Addison is NFL ready and can instantly produce. He may struggle with the physicality of stronger corners. If Addison can overcome that or add to his frame he can be a true #1 versatile weapon. If not, Addison projects as a solid #2 receiver.

Strengths:

Route Running
Suddenness
3-Level Receiver
Deep Threat

Weaknesses:

Frame
Not An Elite Athlete
Can Get Pushed Outside
Contested Catch Physicality

Grade: Middle First

2. Jaxon Smith-Njigba (#19)

Ohio St. – (6'1" 196 lbs)

Jaxon Smith-Njigba's 2021 season vaulted him to the top of the receiver rankings. There's an argument to be made that Smith-Njigba had a better season than teammates Chris Olave and Garrett Wilson, two rising NFL stars. He recorded 1,595 yards with 4.01 yards per route run, before capping it off with a record breaking 347-3 in the Rose Bowl. Unfortunately JSN missed the majority of 2022 with a hamstring injury, but his previous tape was enough to depend on.

JSN simply understands how to play the receiver position perfectly. He runs criss, sudden routes with timing and nuance. He utilizes leverage and will find the hole in any zone. His hands are consistent and he snags balls with body control and concentration. JSN is a possession monster who thrives on short and intermediate routes. He has a shifty release with the instincts of a star receiver. He's one of the few receivers in the class that consistently ran a full route tree.

Most of JSN's limitations are purely physical. While he is extremely fluid, JSN isn't an elite, dynamic athlete. JSN lacks the breakaway speed to be a YAC threat. His role as a pure slot player that doesn't stretch the field lowers his draft stock. He's a very safe bet, but doesn't bring the ceiling of a game breaking receiver. While he didn't run the 40, JSN's agility numbers were encouraging with a 99th percentile 3-Cone and Shuttle. Jaxon Smith-Njigba is the most pro ready receiver in the class. He profiles as an instant productive slot option who will thrive against zone coverage. His role is limited by his athleticism and size, and won't rotate to the outside. You know what you're drafting with JSN, an impressive possession slot receiver.

Strengths:

Nuanced Route Running

Fluid

Pro Ready

Zone Beater

Weaknesses:

High End Athleticism

YAC

Pure Slot

Average Size

Grade: Mid/Late First

3. Quentin Johnston (#21)

TCU – (6'3" 208 lbs)

Quentin Johnston, my top receiver in the class, has the highest ceiling of the group. He carries a prototype frame for an X receiver, while being a freak athlete at that size. His acceleration, twitch and speed at nearly 6'3 "is off the charts, with the power of an even bigger receiver. Johnston is fluid with great body control and the physical ability to stop routes quickly. He's an obvious deep threat that's more than capable of stretching his field. He's also an elite Yac threat that is shifty and explosive with the ball in his hands. Quentin's jumps of 40.5" (97%) and 11'2 (99%) at the combine were elite, but his pro day testing didn't quite live up to expectations. He ran an unofficial 7.33 (17%) 3-Cone and ran a 4.52 (69%) forty yard dash. There's no doubting Quentin's explosiveness, but questions may have arisen on his change of direction

Johnston dominated a few games this year (14/206 vs Kansas, 8/180 vs Oklahoma), but was practically shutout against Georgia in the title game with only one catch for three yards. His quarterback play was inconsistent, (sorry to the Max Duggan fanclub) with many times that Johnson was wide open and not targeted. While his ceiling is limitless, Quentin is by no means a finished product. He stands upright, and while he has the movement skills to improve, his routes are unpolished.

Quentin's biggest concern is body catching. He tracks the ball well and has the traits to be an elite contested catch threat, but he lets the ball hit his pads. This is a big red flag for receivers and must be fixed immediately. His contested catch rate of 34.8% is embarrassing with his length profile. Quentin's polish is well below JSN and Addison, but his potential as an alpha X vaults him to the top. He is an explosive threat that will contribute as a rookie with deep plays and screens at the least. If Quentin can refine his route running and fix his body catching he'll be an elite WR1, but he has more work to do than the other top receivers.

Strengths:

Table Of Contents

Insane Athlete+
Speed/Size Combo
YAC Threat
Deep Threat
Ball Tracking

Weaknesses:

Body Catching+
Raw Route Running
Upright Stance

Grade: Late First

+ Jalin Hyatt (#42)

Tennessee – (6'0" 176 lbs)

Jalin Hyatt was the breakout receiver of the college season. Headlining an exciting Tennessee offense, Hyatt torched defenses with 1,267 yards (5th) and 15 (2nd) touchdowns. He performed against many top defenses, including a 207 yards and 5 TD game against Alabama. Hyatt is a bonafide deep threat, with unteachable game changing speed. He uses his quickness and fluid motions to run routes. He'll challenge any team deep, opening up closer options for his teammates. Most of his game is still raw, but Hyatt produced in college nonetheless. He has room to grow as a route runner and didn't run a full route tree. Hyatt is very slim and NFL physicality is a big concern. Tennessee schemed him perfectly with motion and stacks, allowing him to never play press coverage. He'll have to adjust to constant press, another problem with his transition to an NFL system. Hyatt has potential to be a possession receiver, but rarely ran shorter in breaking routes.

Hyatt's profile consists purely of speed and explosion. His traits give him a high ceiling as a prospect, but he is far less well rounded than the other top receivers. Adjusting to press and NFL strength will be tough for Hyatt and he may struggle as a rookie. The risk of a speed receiver is higher, especially with his lankiness, but his athleticism, nuance and production are worth betting on. While it's a far leap from his

gimmicky college option, Hyatt has the potential to grow into a true X receiver. He will immediately slot in as a deep threat.

Strengths:

Deep Threat+
Fluid
Long Build
Speed
X Potential

Weaknesses:

Raw and Sloppy Route Runner
Thin Frame – NFL Physicality
WR Friendly Air Raid Scheme/Limited Press
Route Tree

Grade: Middle Second

5. Xavier Hutchinson (#52)

Iowa St. – (6'2" 203 lbs)

Xavier Hutchinson is the most underrated receiver in this year's draft class. A common pattern is that college receivers who are targeted so frequently that the defense knows the ball will be going to them, and that receiver still produces very well, that receiver oftentimes turns out to be a good NFL receiver. This year there is no prospect that fits that mold better than Xavier Hutchinson. He was the most targeted receiver in college football, and dominated the stat sheet with 107 catches (3rd) and 1,171 yards (8th). Hutch lined up everywhere and has the frame to play outside. He is extremely skilled with a good release, route running, footwork and hands. He is especially nuanced when facing man coverage and properly manipulates corners. Simply said, Xavier "knows how to play the receiver position". He runs a full route tree and offers YAC ability.

Hutchinson's biggest concern is his athleticism. He is by no means a bad athlete, but lacks the insane traits of the high end players. He is decently fluid for his size, but lacks explosion and long speed. He relies more on his skill and route running

Table Of Contents

for separation rather than his athleticism. His testing reflected this with a 6.79 RAS which is extremely mediocre. He also needs to beef up and may struggle with NFL physicality at the catch point. Hutchinson doesn't offer the high ceiling of a top-50 prospect, but has a very solid floor. He draws similarities to Amon-Ra St. Brown, another prospect with elite college production and skill, but lacked the explosive traits to be a high selection. I'm not suggesting that Hutchinson will be a receiver of Amon-Ra's caliber, but their profiles were both overlooked. If he is able to overcome his athletic questions, Hutchinson can be a true starting X receiver. If not, he's a great rotational/backend starter WR.

Strengths:

Receiver Instincts

Ball Skills

Nuanced Route Runner

College Production

Weaknesses:

Average Athlete

Slender/NFL Physicality

Average Quickness

Grade: Late Second/Early Third

6. Josh Downs (#62)

UNC – (5'9" 171 lbs)

Josh Downs has been a force in college football, with two straight seasons of 1,000+ yards. He is a shifty slot option with high end speed. He can turn on the second gear and knows how to beat zones. He has a quick release and moves extremely well. Downs is a good route runner with a lot of digs and curls in his repertoire. He's a smart, instinctual football player who knows how to blend his traits without the ball in his hands.

His size is the big downside, as it severely limits his role in the NFL. While he has the skill to win contested catches (72.2% Contested Catch Rate, 2nd in CFB), NFL corners will take advantage of his frame. Downs would occasionally run sloppy routes,

but I expect that to fully go away. He doesn't have the frame to play outside and was able to use his quickness to avoid physicality in college. His combine stats didn't blow me away (7.79 RAS), but Downs looked super composed and natural during the on field drills. He's more of a middle of the field winner than a true deep threat.

Downs profiles as a slot option who is easily utilized in a quick passing scheme. His ceiling may be limited by his frame, but he has an NFL ready skillset. Downs is one of the more talented players in the draft, but unfortunately his role is less valued in the NFL.

Strengths:

Speed/Shifty

Uses Speed Well

Short Game

Weaknesses:

Frame

NFL physicality

Limited Slot Role

Grade: Early Third

7. Michael Wilson (#64)

Stanford – (6'2" 213 lbs)

Michael Wilson is an interesting profile, breaking out as a sophomore before being plagued by injuries these past two seasons. He only played in six games this season and his health concerns carry an understandable risk. Wilson is a nuanced receiver who manipulates and stacks corners with routes. He's a smooth route runner that uses his size when making cuts. Wilson tracks balls well with good hands. He possesses a diverse release package and has solid juice. Everything about his game is usually smooth and composed. Wilson played in a disappointing Stanford offense with poor QB play. He wins on the intermediate level very well.

Michael Wilson isn't an overly explosive athlete. He isn't a burner and relies on skill more than juice to get separation. Wilson's physicality at the catch point is underwhelming for his size. He obviously had limited production and his medicals will

Table Of Contents

be big for teams. Wilson thrust himself into the draft spotlight with an outstanding Senior Bowl. He was unguardable in drills, beating corners with his shiftiness and route running. Wilson played like the best receiver in Mobile that week, impressive everyone in attendance. His inability to stay on the field drops his grade, but he has impressive pure skill at his size. Wilson has WR1 potential and will most likely start out as a rotational receiver, most likely developing into a solid WR2.

Strengths:

Frame/Juice Combo

Route Running

Release Package

Combine Performance

Weaknesses:

Injuries+

Not Overly Explosive

Catch Point Physicality

Grade: Early Third

8. A.T. Perry (#66)

Wake Forest – (6'3" 198 lbs)

A.T Perry has the benefit of being a lengthy receiver in a much smaller class. He takes advantage of his length and 33" arms, using it to snag balls that corners can't get to. For his size, Perry has good juice and acceleration off the line. He backed up his film with an impressive 9.23 RAS combine performance. Perry has nuanced instincts as a route runner, knows how to stack will on inside cuts, blend moves together and manipulate defender leverage. These skills aren't common in young receivers, and Perry really impressed with his knowledge of the game. Perry is an obvious read zone threat and security blanket receiver. He has great ball skills and has some YAC ability as well. Perry was a college standout with two straight years of 1,100 yards and 10+ TDs.

A.T. Perry has to add mass to his frame, as corners will out-physical him on the sideline. His route contact suffers from his build, which means even more for a

receiver without elite explosive traits. He runs a unique slow, composed release and his press break needs improvement. Perry is an unorthodox route runner who can drift on some plays. Refining his technique and becoming a more consistent down to down runner is a big step for him. While Perry can get separation, he isn't a true breakaway threat and must tighten up his play style to continue being a deep threat.

Perry profiles as a versatile receiver with a full route tree to play at any level. Without elite explosiveness he's not an overly "dangerous" weapon, but can be a quality possession receiver. WR3 as a rookie that can develop into a WR2 and a red zone threat.

Strengths:

Length/Catch Radius

Body Control/Ball Skills

Redzone

Well Rounded

College Production

Weaknesses:

Thin/Physicality

Loose Routes

Limited Release Package

Elite Athleticism

Grade: Early Third

9. Zay Flowers (#67)

Boston College – (5'9" 182 lbs)

While the media is super high on Zay Flowers, with some even calling him the best receiver in the draft, I'm significantly lower on his NFL outlook. He's insanely fluid and shifty, practicality scooting down the field. Flowers is extremely instinctual and finds holes against zones. With the ball in his hands Zay Flowers is a natural, weaving in between the defense. He tracks the ball well and gets separation on his nuanced routes. Zay comes from a family of thirteen siblings. He chose to stay four years at

Table Of Contents

Boston College so he could become the first in his family to graduate college. He's a hard worker with the type of personality that should fit in any locker room.

That said, the weaknesses in his game are overlooked. Not only does he have a very small frame, Flowers' range is limited with only 29" arms. Flowers won't win many contested catches and will deal with heavy physicality on his routes. He had drop problems at Boston College, dropping 10 balls (4th in CFB). Flowers has a better shot at playing reps outside than some of the other small receivers, but will most likely end up as a primary slot option. He has incredible short quickness, but doesn't have the deep speed of the elite deep threats. As a much smaller receiver, his combine performance wasn't anything special – recording a 7.65 RAS. Flowers doesn't have the freaky athleticism that other small receivers rely on. He didn't attack the middle of the field and played more deep and sideline routes. There's no denying his pure talent, but his role as a tiny slot option without high end traits isn't valued highly in the modern league. Flowers will have to accommodate himself to NFL physicality early on and fix his drops issues, but he can produce early on.

Strengths:

YAC Threat+

Deep Threat

Fluid/Movement Skills

Nuance and Instincts

Weaknesses:

Tiny Frame

NFL Physicality

Slot Role

Not Elite Athlete For His Size

Grade: Early Third

10. Marvin Mims (#88)

Oklahoma – (5'11" 283 lbs)

Marvin Mims has been Oklahoma's primary weapon for the past few seasons, racking up 2,400 yards and 20 touchdowns in his college career. He has phenomenal

Table Of Contents

movement skills, accelerating quickly and fluidly changing his speed. Mims can be a deep threat and runs great double move routes. He has soft hands and tracks the ball very well. Mims finds holes well against zones and runs many crossing routes.

Most of Mims's weaknesses stem from his very small frame. He lined up everywhere in college, but lacks the size to play outside and will likely be pigeonholed into the slot. Mims will struggle with big NFL corners who can push him off his route. His size limits his tackle breaking and Mims doesn't offer much YAC.

Between his route running and field stretching, Mims has the skill to be a versatile receiver. However, his lack of size will be a big challenge to overcome. He did have horrendous QB play this season, so maybe his talent will flourish further with better passes. Mims had an encouraging combine performance, running a 4.38 40 (95%), jumping 39.5" (94%) and posting an impressive 9.13 RAS. Mims can be a versatile WR3 with deep threat ability and can improve into a good WR2 option if he adds muscle to his frame.

Strengths:

Movement Skills

Finding Holes

Deep Threat

Changing Speeds

College Production

Double Moves

Weaknesses:

Contested Catch/Limited Length At Catch Point

Physicality vs Press, Sidelines and Overall Routes

Size

Grade: Late Third

II. Tyler Scott (#89)

Cincinnati – (5'10" 177 lbs)

Tyler Scott is yet another Cincinnati speed receiver to enter the draft. Speed is the name of Scott's game, as he involves it in practically everything he does on the

football field. Besides threatening defenses with it, he uses speed to run sudden routes. His stop/start ability is special and he has explosive one-cut routes. Scott has the ball tracking to complement his deep threat status. His 16.4 Yards per Reception showcased his ability to stretch the field.

Tyler Scott is a very small and slender receiver and isn't a physical player. He needs to put on weight as corners will be able to body Scott if they get their hands on him. His hands aren't good enough for him to be a possession receiver. Scott can round his routes and needs to clear that up at the NFL level. He ran a 4.44 40 which is fast, but was disappointing for someone with Scott's expectations. His film showed enough to give overwhelming confidence about his twitch, and he reinforced his explosiveness by jumping 39.5' (94%) and 11'1 (98%).

Scott's evaluation is pretty straightforward and depends on your prioritization of a speed receiver. I think Scott has the skill to be more than just a speed guy and win middle of the field routes. His tape showed the ability to efficiently use his speed for more than just deep routes, a trait that is heavily overlooked. He profiles as a deep threat who can attack the boundary. As a rookie, I expect Scott to be used as a field stretcher/rotational WR who can become a solid starter.

Strengths:

Elite Speed
Deep Threat
Twitchy Routes

Weaknesses:

Physicality
Inconsistent Hands
Very Lean

Grade: Late Third

12. Trey Palmer (#93)

Nebraska – (6'0" 192 lbs)

Trey Palmer was Nebraska's goto receiving option with nine touchdowns and over 1,000 yards this season. He played a majority of his snaps in the slot and will stay

there in the NFL. Palmer wins best with his movement skills. He bursts off the line and quickly accelerates into top speed. His route running is solid, but has the potential to improve a significant amount with coaching. Palmer's functional speed is "impressive", but his composure while running is even more impressive. He ran a 4.33 40 at the Combine, reinforcing his athletic abilities.

Palmer's game at Nebraska consisted of mostly vertical routes and screens. He tracks the ball well and uses suddenness on routes to attack defenses deep. He has a thin frame and lacks the physicality needed to play outside. He won't be breaking many tackles or winning contested catches, as Palmer will struggle against the stronger physical NFL CB's. His role as a bigger slot option is less valued than the traditional X receiver, especially with his slender frame. However, if his speed is utilized to open up the middle of the field, Palmer can be a valuable offensive addition. He profiles as a rotational slot option as he adjusts to NFL physicality, who can become an average/solid slot receiver.

Strengths:

Movement Skills

Composure

Deep Threat

Speed

College Production

Weaknesses:

Physicality

Tackle Breaking

Slot Fit

Grade: Late Third/Early Fourth

13. Rashee Rice (#96)

SMU – (6'1" 204 lbs)

Rashee Rice has been one of the toughest evals in the draft. He has been ultra productive for the Mustangs, with 1,344 yards (3rd in CFB) and ten touchdowns this season. He has a bulky NFL build. He lacks elite speed but moves well for his size. Rice

Table Of Contents

has YAC ability and can break tackles, but doesn't break away from the defense. He dealt with some drop issues but has good hands overall and is excellent at contested catches. He ran fluid but raw and sometimes sloppy routes. There were plays when Rice jogged on routes and seemingly didn't give full effort. However, he's a very willing and successful downfield blocker. Rice has elite balance but is not very shifty. He releases quickly off the line, but can afford to develop some new release moves.

Rice thrives on the perimeter, especially on the comeback, go route option, but his route tree overall was severely limited in college and has the potential to run a lot more. His athleticism overall was confusing. He doesn't have the route running to lean on for separation and didn't show a ton of explosive athleticism. He is very skilled but lacks a truly elite defining skill. Contested catch receivers who struggle with separation are a recipe for failure, and I'm concerned that Rice may fall into that territory. He measured in at 6'1, lower than expected, which hurts his status as a contested catch guy. Combine week was massive for him and he tested extremely well, jumping 41" (98%) and scoring a 9.65 RAS. He ran a 4.51 40 which doesn't bode well for his long speed.

Rashee Rice has the build and potential to be a versatile X receiver. Most of his game is pretty raw and improvised and while he does a little bit of everything, he lacks a dominant skill to rely on as a rookie. His tape was extremely inconsistent between games, making his profile all the more confusing. He's definitely a low floor/high ceiling prospect that wouldn't surprise me no matter how his career turns out.

Strengths:

Build
Tackle Breaking
Fluid
Ball Instincts
Balance
Blocking
College Production

Weaknesses:

Sometimes Sluggish
Breakaway Speed
Route Tree

Raw Route Runner

Grade: Late Third/Early Fourth

14. Cedric Tillman (#97)

Tennessee – (6'3" 213 lbs)

The “other” Tennessee receiver alongside Jalin Hyatt, Tillman was actually the better performer in 2021. His 64 receptions for 1,081 and 12 TD's put him on the map for prospects to look for this season. Unfortunately Tillman was dealing with an injury all season, and his tape was nowhere near the same.

In a class of small receivers, Tillman stands out with prototypical X size. He uses his frame well at the catch point to body defenders and win contested catches. He's a very strong blocker and gives full effort. While he lacks breakaway speed, Tillman is fast for his frame. He can beat press and is very physical with contact, especially when using his body to win on middle of the field routes. However, Tillman lacked the juice this year to scare corners off the line. He has decent route running, but not good enough to be a separation player. His well rounded profile can be a positive, but receivers nowadays need a way to threaten corners. His YAC this year was also underwhelming.

Overall, Cedric's tape this year didn't resemble a top prospect. I hope that he can fully return to his 2021 play, where he had more juice as a runner. He's already an older, 5th year prospect and his injury was tough considering he's already labeled a “contested catch receiver”. If he can fully recover Tillman can be a well rounded WR2/3, with more juice, better route running, and the speed to win deep. He lacks an outstanding trait to vault him as a prospect, but he has a balanced skill set of size, speed, hands and route running to earn playing time.

Strengths:

Frame

Contested Catch

Utilizing Size

Blocking

Well Rounded

2021 Production

Weaknesses:

Limited Juice This Year

No Elite Trait

2022 Separation

Grade: Early Fourth

15. Andrei Iosivas (#104)

Princeton – (6'3" 205 lbs)

Andrei Iosivas is a simple evaluation for a very non-traditional prospect. Iosivas takes the developmental receiver label to the next level. He has an ideal build, allowing teams to play him all over the line. Iosivas made himself known with his freaky athleticism. He has downfield speed and is very fluid. Iosivas has the movement skills and overall burst of a top receiver.

The obvious questions come from his status as a Princeton receiver. Iosivas faced little to no competition as a receiver and the jump to the NFL is massive. Everything about his game is raw, from body catching to route running. He doesn't yet have the technique of an NFL starter. Like many small school prospects, Iosivas was a big Senior Bowl name and showed he can hang with top prospects. His combine performance was as expected, running a 4.43 40 (90%), jumping 39" and 10'8 (92%), and scoring a 9.92 RAS (92%). Similarly to Christian Watson, Iosivas steps into the NFL as one of the best athletes in the league. However, Iosivas is even more raw and untested than Watson. Iosivas showed the instincts to develop his skills but at 23 years old, it's tough to bet on an older prospect to make that significant a jump. Iosivas is a pure deep threat/YAC weapon early on if he gets playing time, with an elite ceiling that is lightyears away.

Strengths:

Instincts

Traits

Build/Length

Combine Performance

Weaknesses:

Very Raw

Overall Technique

Body Catches

Competition

Grade: Fourth

16. Kayshon Boutte (#108)

LSU – (5'11" 195 lbs)

Boutte's decline as a prospect is as intriguing as it is disappointing. Boutte had an impressive freshman season, flashing high end talent and NFL traits. The expectations for his two years were set very high, and Boutte failed to live up to them. His numbers went down both seasons as Boutte also struggled to stay healthy. Boutte has tons of juice and is very explosive with the ball. He is a fluid slot receiver with big play ability. He has a big frame for a slot and uses it to break tackles. Boutte knows how to find openings in zones.

You never want a prospect's earlier tape to be his best, and it's worth investigating what really happened behind the scenes. He struggled with drop issues and sloppy, undisciplined routes. Boutte needs to be stronger at the catch point and his tape was very inconsistent. There were various off-field rumors this season, including some outlandish party stories, and Boutte announced he was returning for another year at LSU before re-committing to the draft a few weeks later. He needed a big combine to reiterate his status as a top prospect, but his testing was horrendous, posting a 4.74 RAS. His injuries may have not fully healed from the season, and hampered him at Indi.

It's hard to bet on a receiver with both inconsistent tape, off field rumors and poor testing. Teams will get a steal if Boutte can return to form on the field, but he is sliding down draft boards. His undisciplined nature on the is obvious through his sloppy routes and drops, but he also has superstar fluidity and big play ability. Boutte has high potential from the slot, but needs to piece his game together and mature as a receiver. He can bust completely, but you can't fully ignore the first round traits.

Strengths:

Table Of Contents

Fluid/Movement Skills

Contested Catch

YAC Threat

Explosive and Athletic

Versatile in Slot

Zone Beater

Weaknesses:

Sloppy/Undisciplined Routes

Drops

Contested Catches

Regression/Off Field

Grade: Fourth

Tight Ends



The most important aspect for a top Tight End prospect is possessing a special trait or a way to stand out amongst the NFL TE's. In the NFL there's a handful of elite Tight Ends, a few pro bowl level players, then a large number of solid to average starters. Teams have drafted many safer, pro ready tight end prospects, only for them to fail to break into the top two tiers. Athleticism is the primary factor that can vault a Tight End into an upper tier. Combine testing is extremely valuable and is a clear indicator for success. I look for juice and fluidity when running routes, and the ability to create separation similar to a receiver. Tight Ends need to sink into their routes smoothly and create YAC plays. Blocking is another key aspect that can solidify a top prospect. This is an elite Tight End class at the top with many different styles and "flavors".

1. Darnell Washington (#28)

Georgia – (6'6" 264 lbs)

Table Of Contents

Unique draft prospects rise high in the draft, which is exactly the case with Darnell Washington. Washington is a physical freak, measuring in at an astonishing 6'6 264 lbs. He is easily the best blocking tight end in the class and can play the rare role of a 6th offensive lineman. That alone gives him high value for a heavy running team. He was mostly used as a blocker at Georgia, with TE phenom Brock Bowers receiving the heavy share of targets. Washington was only targeted 43 times this year, but it's reasonable to suggest he would have recorded higher counting stats on any other team. He is a clunky runner without high end speed on tape, with stiff movements when making cuts. Washington had some highlight plays, but looked slow off his release. His frame allowed him to body corners on contested catches and shrug off tacklers.

Washington's obvious concerns was his juice as a receiver and had a big combine week ahead of him. He silenced all doubts and put on a record breaking show at Indianapolis. Washington ran a crazy 4.64 40 (90%), 4.08 shuttle (98%) and jumped 10'2 in the broad (91%). He did all as one of the biggest tight ends in NFL history while also measuring with 34 ½ arms (long enough to play OT) and historic 11" hands. If all goes wrong, Washington has the athleticism, skill and size to attempt a conversion to offensive tackle. Washington was put on an island against premium edge rushers and held his own against Will Anderson. His absurd strength and frame profile give him elite blocking potential, that he can develop if he lowers his pad level. Washington is a good contested catch, security blanket tight end who can break tackles. He is too clunky to be a true vertical threat, but has the functional athleticism to produce as a receiver. Washington is an immediate starter from his blocking alone and will grow as a receiver.

Strengths:

Massive Frame+
Elite Blocking Potential
Contested Catch/Redzone
Hands
Combine Performance

Weaknesses:

Receiving Production
Stiff Movements

High Pad Level

Grade: Late First/Early Second

2. Michael Mayer (#30)

Notre Dame – (6'4" 249 lbs)

Michael Mayer is the most pro ready tight end in the class. He's been uber productive for Notre Dame the last two seasons, placing in the top three in catches, yards and touchdowns while breaking Notre Dame's all time receptions record. In terms of college performance there's no tight end I'd select over Mayer. He has consistent hands and uses his big frame to box out corners. Mayer was the best red zone threat amongst tight ends this year and is a safe target for a young quarterback. His blocking technique needs some improvement, but Mayer has the ferocity and power that indicates he'll produce as a blocker.

Mayer doesn't have many holes in his game, but also doesn't have the explosiveness or dynamic skillset like some other tight ends in the class. He can be a solid contributor in a passing game, but don't expect him to be a teams #1 option that can carry an offense. Mayer lacks elite speed and juice, recording an expected 4.7 40 (80%) and 32.5" vert (55%). He doesn't have the elite receiving upside to be a first rounder. Mayer's evaluation is pretty straightforward. He'll contribute as a rookie and will be a solid well rounded tight end for many years. He's not the athlete of a Kyle Pitts or Darren Waller, and doesn't have the blocking appeal of Darnell Washington. Mayer is a good second round pick for a team looking for that final piece at tight end.

Strengths:

Hands

Frame

Red Zone Threat

College Production

Weaknesses:

Sloppy Blocking

Sloppy Route Running

Lacks Elite Juice

Grade: Early Second

3. Sam LaPorta (#47)

Iowa – (6'3" 245 lbs)

Iowa's offense was horrendous, and Laporta was the lone bright spot. He was Iowa's star weapon with 58 catches for 648 yards, both fourth in college football amongst tight ends. LaPorta has a thick frame with good size as a blocker. His footwork needs improvement, but he is a fluid route runner with plenty of juice. He is fast with sudden movements for a tight end. LaPorta has versatility to line up anywhere and get separation in man coverage. He can run rounded routes and needs to refine his cuts and digs. Laporta utilizes his big frame in the catch point and has good hands.

As a blocker, LaPorta's technique is still sloppy, but he has strong arms and the base to be a blocking threat. He recorded 20 broken tackles which led all tight ends, and is a YAC monster. LaPorta wasn't known as a freaky athlete at Iowa, but performed extremely well at the combine, including a 4.59 40 (94%) and 10'3 broad jump (93%). He placed himself amongst the elite tier of tight end athletes with a 9.26 RAS. LaPorta isn't the flashiest tight end prospect, but is well rounded with attractive traits. He has the speed and fluidity to be a quality receiving option, with the size and power to improve into a premium blocker. LaPorta has a high floor as a versatile TE2 in a passing scheme, with the potential of quality TE1.

Strengths:

Fluid/Juice

Separation

Blocking Potential

Combine Performance

Versatility

Weaknesses:

Blocking Technique

Unpolished Route Running

Only one Touchdown in 2022

Grade: Mid/Late Second

4. Luke Musgrave (#51)

Oregon St. – (6'6" 253 lbs)

Luke Musgrave is one of the big winners of the pre-draft process. The lengthy 6'6 tight end missed most of the season with a knee injury, but was electric in his two starts. He recorded 11 catches for 169 yards and a touchdown while looking extremely explosive on film. Musgrave is a pure receiving threat, with the athleticism and ball skills to disguise as a "tall WR". He uses his big frame well to box out corners and make plays on the ball. He has the traits to contribute on all three levels. Musgrave's height comes with its disadvantages, as Musgrave has trouble sinking his hips to get low and make sharp cuts. His blocking is far from being perfect, but it is passable as a starter.

Musgrave dominated Senior Bowl week, looking unstoppable on 1v1's and recording a ridiculous top speed of 20.05 MPH. He carried the hype over to the Combine, posting an insane 4.61 40 (93%), 10'5 broad (96%) and 9.89 RAS. Musgrave is amongst the most explosive tight ends in the past twenty years. He's hurt by an outstanding tight end class, but could be a top two TE in many other classes. Musgrave floor is a day two selection, but he may be a surprise late first rounder. His lack of reps and limited playing time at Oregon State (80 targets in college career) add mystery to his profile. Musgrave has the tools to be a high ceiling contributing pass catcher. He'll start as a TE2, especially as he refines his blocking, and can develop into a number one tight end.

Strengths:

Frame/Length

Receiving Ability

Athleticism

Senior Bowl/Combine

Weaknesses:

Play Strength

Sinking Hips

Tackle Breaking

Limited Games

Grade: Late Second

5. Dalton Kincaid (#65)

Utah – (6'4" 246 lbs)

Draft media is significantly higher on Dalton Kincaid, with his name cracking the top twenty in some mock drafts. It's easy to see where people fall in love with Kincaid as he's practically a receiver. He runs crisp routes and is very fluid for a tight end. His release is quick and he has tons of juice off the line. Kincaid often lined up as a receiver and has very good ball skills. He finished an impressive season with 70 catches (1st in CFB) for 890 yards (2nd) and 8 touchdowns (2nd). With his receiver-like ability in a tight ends body, teams will easily use him to create mismatches in the passing game.

Kincaid will be one of the smallest tight ends in the league next season. While he gives full effort as a blocker, he lacks the strength to be an above average NFL blocker. His size prevents him from being a team's all around tight end. He'll have to play alongside a bigger, blocking TE. Kincaid is fluid, but he's not the explosive athlete you'd want at his size. He isn't a freaky athlete like many other smaller players at the position. He's also a much older prospect that will be turning twenty four as a rookie. Kincaid dealt with a minor back fracture at the end of the season which gives teams something to look for in his physicals. His injury prevented him from testing at the combine, but he should be good by rookie training.

Kincaid will line up wide and contribute to a team's versatile passing attack. He will have to be extremely productive as a receiver to make up for his lack of blocking. LaPorta, Mayer and Washington all offer better blocking talent, and Kincaid lacks the elite traits of Musgrave to have his incredibly high ceiling as a playmaker. He's not a true TE, but will be a great complementary tight end in a passing game.

Strengths:

Speed/Juice

Fluid/Can Lineup As Receiver

Gets To Second Level

Hands

Production

Weaknesses:

Size

Blocking

Age

Size/Traits Combo

Grade: EarlyThird

6. Tucker Kraft (#82)

SDSU – (6'5" 254 lbs)

Tucker Kraft has been labeled as the “traitsy project” TE, but I’m a bigger fan of his blocking than receiving ability. He had a productive 2021 season, but was injured for most of this year. Kraft’s a muscular tight end with a strong base and a wide upper half. He was a frequent blocker with strength as a gap and second level blocker. His hand technique is sloppy, but his willingness as a blocker indicates he’ll improve.

As a receiver, is a big target with solid long speed, but is a clunky mover. He runs sloppy routes, and drifts on plenty of curls and comebacks. His competition at NDSU was well below the rest of the TE prospects. Kraft tested relatively well (9.58 RAS), but looked stiff on tape. Kraft wasn’t a great man separator and impressed more as an outlet receiver. He has the intensity and strength profile to be a day one starter purely with his blocking upside. Kraft is right below Darnell Washington as a blocker. Kraft’s a good pass catcher in short yardage situations with functional athleticism. His movement skills and route running make him an unlikely high target receiver. Kraft is a good pick to be a TE2 with average TE1 potential as a primary blocker.

Strengths:

Full Blocking Profile

Strength

Long Speed

Weaknesses:

Raw/Sloppy Route Runner

Clunky Movements

Table Of Contents

Separation
Competition

Grade: Middle Third

Offensive Tackles



Quality Offensive Tackles are a rarity in today's NFL, making them one of the most premium picks in the draft. Teams will, and should, jump at an opportunity to solidify their line, especially when protecting a young developing Quarterback. When scouting Tackles, my main focus is the difference between pure athleticism and functional athleticism. Pure athleticism represents the traits that are more easily testable, such as straight line speed, explosiveness and strength. While these traits are vastly important for the position, I tend to look closer at functional athleticism. Functional athleticism is the flexibility and stiffness that allows lineman to move smoothly and mirror defenders. I value a lineman's ability to shift their torso quickly or drop their legs back and cover ground. Linemen with pure athleticism but not functional athleticism will test well at the combine, but are beaten across their face and tend to lean into blocks instead of bending. I hope this distinction helps you evaluate lineman yourself and aids your reading of the Tackles in this year's draft.

1. Paris Johnson Jr. (#4)

Ohio St. – (6'6" 313 lbs)

He may not be the most pro-ready tackle in the class, but Paris Johnson Jr. secures the top offensive lineman spot in this year's draft. Johnson started at right guard in 2021, before switching to the left side this season and keeping the pocket clean for C.J. Stroud. He has a prototype tackle build with long 36" arms. Johnson moves well and covers ground on his quick release. He gets to the second level quickly and is a quality run blocker, especially on zone runs.

Johnson has all the tools to play the position, but is still learning the nuances of left tackle. He has less experience than most top prospects, and with that comes some technique issues. Johnson hand technique is still in development and he's beaten by swim moves and can place his hands too high. His footwork can still be sloppy and can give up leverage at the point of contact. Johnson's body weight composition isn't always steady and leads to him falling off balance. He plays jumpy at times and needs to slow down his rhythm as a blocker. These are all mistakes that Peter Skoronski doesn't have, but the difference is that these mistakes are fixable and should come with more reps and experience. Even with these issues, Johnson was a very good college tackle, and he'll only get better as he spends time in the NFL. He has all the tools to be a long term answer at left tackle. He might struggle as a rookie with unpolished technique, but his ceiling and fixable issues are too much to pass on.

Strengths:

Frame

Strong Arms

Traits

Zone/Second Level Blocking

Weaknesses:

Footwork

Hand Placement

Body weight Distribution

Grade: Top Twelve

2. Peter Skoronski (#13)

Northwestern – (6'4" 313 lbs)

Peter Skoronski won't be for everyone, but he is the most polished pass blocker in the draft. His obvious limitation is his arm length at only 32 $\frac{1}{4}$ ". The usual arm length threshold to play tackle is having arms over thirty three inches. Skoronski would have the shorter arms of any tackle in the league, and some teams won't even give him a shot to play on the edge. Skoronski has nearly perfected his pass blocking skills, and has phenomenal 1v1 abilities. He mirrors edge rushers and was able to lock down many of the ones he faced. Skoronski identifies blitzers and releases quickly off the line. He isn't incredibly strong or fast, but is good enough of an athlete for it to not be an issue. Skoronski compensates for his athleticism with his incredible hand usage. He has the best hand placement of any tackle in the draft, disengaging opponents arms with swipes and pulls.

Skoronski was put on an island, usually able to win his reps quite easily with technique. His run blocking is solid but he isn't a force that can move defenders. Skoronski isn't as productive on the second level and can miss defenders in zone runs. His dominance in college was obvious and Skoronski has the most pro ready skill set of any offensive lineman this year. His athletic and length limitations aren't something he can change, and it limits him from being an elite NFL tackle. Experienced edge rushers may take advantage of the arm length difference and abuse Skoronski's reach. If he can't play tackle, Skoronski can easily slide into guard where he'll make a tremendous impact at the position. He'll be a consistent staple on the offensive line, no matter what position he plays his career at.

Strengths:

Hand Usage+

Mirroring/Footwork

Polished

Pass Blocking

Weaknesses:

Length (Tiny Arms)

Average Run blocker

Elite Athletic Traits

Might Be Moved Inside

Grade: Top Twelve (Lower If He's a Guard)

3. Anton Harrison (#20)

Oklahoma – (6'4" 312 lbs)

Despite producing at left tackle the past two seasons for Oklahoma, Anton Harrison has been “lost” amongst the top tackle prospects. Harrison completely fits in as a first round prospect that has NFL ready pass protection. He holds his own in 1v1's, mirroring well and setting his feet. Harrison has adequate hand placement in pass protection and uses his hands often. He's light on his feet and can get to the edge first.

Where Harrison needs to improve is run blocking. He has a solid base and can hold his ground, but he isn't an aggressive or powerful mover. Harrison is a clunky second level blocker that is unsure of himself in open space. He isn't a special athlete, but is definitely one of the better athletes in the draft. Pass protection is more valuable in the modern NFL, and Harrison is ready to protect his quarterback as a rookie. He'll need to work on run blocking, especially his second level technique. His run blocking is mostly fixable and Anton can turn into an all around solid left tackle, which is extremely hard to find in the NFL.

Strengths:

Good Build/Base

Pass Protection

Mirroring

Agile

Weaknesses:

Aggression

Not A Mover

Second Level Blocking

Run Game Technique/Hand Placement

Grade: Late First

4. Dawand Jones (#25)

Ohio St. – (6'8" 374 lbs)

Dawand Jones might be the largest football player to ever exist. At a monstrous 6'8" and 374 lbs, Jones measured out a 7'6" wingspan, the longest ever recorded at the Senior Bowl. Not to be forgotten, are his massive 11 $\frac{3}{4}$ " hands and his 36 $\frac{1}{2}$ " arms. Naturally, Dawand Jones mauls defenders as a run defender. He punishes rushers and finishing blocks on the second level. Jones was quicker than you'd expect at his size getting to the second level. He's difficult to bullrush and uses his hands often.

Other ginormous prospects such as Daniel Faalele have greatly struggled as pass protectors. This is not the case with Dawand Jones, and while he's far from perfect, he successfully protected C.J. Stroud from opposing rushers. Jones didn't allow a single hit or sack and recorded a CFB leading 1.3% pressure rate. He identifies stunts and second level blitzers. Dawand Jones utilized his length with his signature go-to snatch trap block. His size does limit him in some aspects, including slowing down his release. Jones needs to cover more ground in pass set dropbacks as his edge setting speed is concerning. Dawand can mirror edge rushers, but lacks lateral quickness. Jones shoots his hands too high, which gives up leverage and leaves him vulnerable.

Dawand Jones was the best player at the Senior Bowl. He practiced for one day in mobile and shut down practically every rusher he faced. Not only did he dominate with his size and power, Jones showed the ability to win 1v1 pass sets against quicker edge rushers. Dawand Jones profiles as a day one starting right tackle. He'll utilize his unteachable traits to be an immediate force as a run blocker, while holding his own in pass protection. Jones has necessary pass blocking improvements, especially fixing his hand placement. His lateral quickness limits him against speed rushers, but Jones will lock down power attempts. Dawand Jones should be a solid starter with pro bowl expectations. If he fails as a pass protector, his worst case scenario is profiling as a strict power run blocker.

Strengths:

Massive Frame and Length+
Run Game (Especially Power)
Base/Strength
College Production
Senior Bowl Practice

Weaknesses:

Hand Placement

Occasional Leaning

Dealing With Edge Speed

Pure RT

Grade: Late First

5. Broderick Jones (#29)

Georgia – (6'5" 311 lbs)

Looking at Broderick Jones, he doesn't fit the usual mold of an offensive lineman. Broderick is lengthy, but is a slimmer, muscular tackle. He started full-time for the first time this year and was a capable starter for Georgia. Even with minimal experience, Broderick is a smart player with high end football IQ. Broderick has strong arms that control rushers once locked in. Locking into defenders is one of Broderick's best traits, and one that he uses to succeed as a run defender. He is extremely violent and will not give up on a play. Broderick gets to the second level quickly and motions well. His mirroring is solid and he has a strong base. Broderick still needs to refine his hand placement, but uses his hands often and shows signs of improvement.

Broderick is a pure speed/power/explosiveness athlete and ran a 4.97 forty yard dash. Unfortunately, Broderick's upper body is stiff and he isn't an extremely fluid mover. Edge rushers were able to win outside and cross his face. Pass set fluidity is one of the most important aspects of a high end tackle and Broderick is not an elite athlete in that aspect. His kick needs to be longer so he can gain more ground on pass set dropbacks. Upper body stiffness is less of an issue at guard and Broderick can become an intimidating guard if tackle doesn't work out. Broderick Jones profiles as an average starter tackle. He's capable enough to be a passable starter but doesn't have the athletic profile of a high ceiling tackle. Broderick's technical issues are fixable and he is still improving as a blocker.

Strengths:

NFL Strength

Cerebral BlockerFrame

Table Of Contents

Movement Blocking/Second Level
Control
Mirroring

Weaknesses:

Stiff Upper Body
Not An Elite Athlete
Short Steps

Grade: Early Second

6. Blake Freeland (#45)

BYU – (6’8” 302 lbs)

Blake Freeland was one of the nation’s top left tackles this season, grading a 91.0 (2nd in the nation after Joe Alt!) and a 99.2 pass block efficiency. He is as tall as lineman get at almost 6’8”. Freeland’s weight at that size is disappointing, and teams will attempt to add fifteen to twenty pounds to his frame. He is a physical run defender who thrived in power runs, using his strong arms to pancake defenders. Freeland adjusts well when facing power and has a strong base. His experience shows with 2,690 career snaps. Freeland identifies stunts and blitzes and will have no trouble adjusting to complicated NFL schemes. On tape, Freeland lacks the play speed to scare rushers. Both his feet and hands are slow and he is easily knocked off balance. Freeland packs most of his weight on his tall upper half which encourages defenders to gain leverage and push him off his feet.

Every time I turned on Blake Freeland’s BYU tape I saw a player who’s technique was limited by his athleticism and slow play. This is exactly what made Freeland one of my biggest combine risers when he completely destroyed all the drills at Indianapolis. Freeland is a multi-sport athlete that was a former Gatorade player of the year in high school, and must’ve drank some of Steve Young’s Mormon Milk before testing. He started off by running a 4.98 forty (94%) with a 1.69 ten yard split (98%), both putting him amongst the NFL’s elite testers He then jumped a near perfect 37” vertical (99%) and 10’ broad jump (99%). His 7.46 3-Cone (90%) showcased agility that I simply didn’t see on tape. Freeland’s 9.82 RAS established him as one of the most athletic tackle

Table Of Contents

prospects in the last twenty years. Freeland's grade jumped up a full round as a result, making him an enticing second round tackle selection. He'll still need to pack on mass and his leverage and balance issues aren't going away anytime soon. However athletic he is, Freeland needs to translate his traits into his on the field movements. He'll start out as a swing tackle that can improve into a quality starting offensive tackle.

Strengths:

Power Run Blocking

Smart/Identifying Stunts

Physical

Frame

Pass Pro

Combine Testing

Weaknesses:

Balance/Losing Leverage

Slow Hands

Slow Feet

Grade: Middle Second

7. Darnell Wright (#58)

Tennessee – (6'5" 333 lbs)

Offensive Tackles are hard to find, so it's no surprise that Tennessee's Darnell Wright has been rising up mock drafts. He's played both sides of the line, but started 2022 as a right tackle and projects there in the NFL. Wright has a powerful build with strong arms. His strength is evident in the run game where he's a threat in a gap scheme. Darnell's base makes him hard to bull rush and he'll be able to handle power rushers.

Darnell's pass set footwork is solid and is definitely not a flaw, but he still has plenty of smaller issues to fix. Darnell stands too upright and his bodyweight composition needs work. He leans more than he bends which can get him caught in uncomfortable positions and makes it hard for Darnell to dig low. Darnell's kicks are

short and he sets too laterally (he sets five degrees deep instead of thirty). Most of these issues are fixable with Darnell, but the bigger issue is his lateral stiffness. He's slow from side to side which allows rushers to beat him across his face. Inside/Outside rushers will give Darnell problems and counter him easily. Darnell Wright is agile and quick to get to the second level. Tennessee's offense is designed for quarterback Hendon Hooker to get the ball out quickly, so Darnell blocks were shortened and easier.

He tested well at the combine with a 5.01 forty yard dash (93%) and a 9'7" broad jump (97%). His 9.78 RAS reflects his explosive traits, but doesn't quiet his stiffness concerns. Darnell is a natural gap blocker and won't be as productive in a zone scheme. He doesn't consistently win zone angles and misses stunt blocks. Darnell can get to the second level, but misses some open space blocks. Darnell Wright performed well against Will Anderson, using his natural power to bottle up some of Anderson's insane explosiveness. Darnell lacks the fluidity to play left tackle, but is a potential starting right tackle option. Outside of his stiffness, Darnell will improve on plenty of his college issues and grow as a pass blocker. There's a chance Darnell is too stiff to play outside, but has the measures to be a quality starting right tackle in a gap scheme.

Strengths:

Strong Arms

Frame/Base

Eyes

Combine Testing

Weaknesses:

Lateral Stiffness

Bodyweight Composition

Polishing Footwork

Grade: Late Second/Middle Third

8. Wanya Morris (#77)

Oklahoma – (6'5" 307 lbs)

Oklahoma's Wanya Morris is an exciting project tackle. He has the perfect size and length with massive 35" arms. Wanya packs muscle on his frame and translates his strength into his arms. He has all the tools to be a great NFL tackle, but still has ways to go fundamentally. Wanya is erratic and unbalanced, leading him to miss defenders in space. He can also be uncontrolled as a run blocker and has poor footwork in pass sets. Wanya's hand usage is his savior as a technical blocker and gives coaches another piece to develop around. Improving into a starting tackle means fully retooling his run blocking technique while completely overhauling his footwork. There are few athletes of Wanya's caliber that have the potential of a long term starter. The opportunities to draft one are very slim, so a team with good offensive line coaches will have trouble passing on Wanya. He'll be a backup as a rookie with a high ceiling as a starter.

Strengths:

Full Size Profile

Hand Usage

Strength

Weaknesses:

Complete Footwork Profile

Uncontrolled Run Blocker

Grade: Middle Third

9. Matthew Bergeron (#78)

Syracuse – (6'5" 318 lbs)

Matthew Bergeron is a safer selection at the backend of day two. Bergeron is a quicker, smaller tackle who's nimble and controlled. He has experience identifying stunts and blitzers along with the football IQ to play immediately. Bergeron should take wider steps in pass sets, but the rest of his footwork is sound. His hand placement needs work and he lacks power and punch in his arms. Bergeron moves well and is smooth when stepping back.

Bergeron's pass pro technique is relatively refined, but doesn't have elite athletic traits. He's tenacious at contact, but his base is average and won't scare

defenders. Bergeron performed well against Isaiah Foskey, but the athleticism threshold is insanely high for current NFL tackles. His 33¾” arms are passable for the outside, but he could be moved inside as a decently productive guard. Bergeron may not be strong enough to be a great starting tackle, but has a high floor as an NFL ready swing tackle or guard. Bergeron has experience at both tackle spots and can fill in multiple offensive line positions if needed.

Strengths:

Quick/Nimble

Mirroring

Zone Blocking

Experience At Both Sides

Weaknesses:

Lighter Base

Average Athlete

Lacks Elite Power

Grade: Middle Third

10. Jaelyn Duncan (#81)

Maryland – (6’6” 306 lbs)

Jaelyn Duncan entered the season as a first round prospect, but after a disappointing season he leaves Maryland with more questions and concerns. It’s easy to understand what made Duncan a top-150 prospect coming out of high school. With textbook 6’6” 306 lbs size, Duncan has a strong base and is extremely agile. He is aggressive and attacks defenders with his powerful arms. Outside of his athletic and physical profile, Duncan gives coaches very little to work with. His technique is all over the place and was abused in multiple games. His film against Michigan and Ohio State was awful, with Duncan looking completely lost against prospects Zach Harrison and Mike Morris. Duncan shoots his hands high which gives up leverage easily. It doesn’t help that Duncan stands upright, allowing rushers to get right under his arms. His kickstep needs to be faster along with his release needing to cover more ground.

Table Of Contents

Duncan is beaten off the edge and struggles to defend counter moves. His strengths as a blocker come from his athleticism, where he has the speed to get to the second level and is a solid power run blocker. He's functional when facing power rushes and can hold his ground.

Jaelyn Duncan is a pure developmental tackle. He is not a rookie starter as his hand placement and technique will get eaten alive by speed rushers and technicians. There are few tackle prospects with Duncan's athletic profile and his ceiling as a functional tackle. He has the traits to slide into guard if tackle doesn't work. Jaelyn Duncan has a lot of improvement to be done, but can develop into a high level pro bowl tackle if all goes right. He can fail as a tackle and have some pretty ugly games, in which case he moves inside and is a rotational guard at worst.

Strengths:

Frame/Build

Strong Arms

Athletic Traits

Weaknesses:

Hand Placement/Technique

Release/Kickstep

Leverage

College Production

Grade: Middle Third

Interior Offensive Line



Interior Offensive Linemen may never be as glorified or valued in the draft as Tackles, but they are a fun position to scout. I think scouts and the general NFL media tend to overcomplicate Lineman scouting. I have a big three when looking at Lineman, which is: experience, athleticism, and production. Especially at Center, you want a player who's proven to be capable of handling line checks and leading the offense. Media tends to obsess over the smaller, quicker lineman, while I tend to focus on winning at contact and functional athleticism (read Tackle intro for more info). With production, many of these prospects are multi year starters who've faced many of the top Interior DLine Prospects. While players that fit this category are obvious high floor prospects, their ceilings tend to get overlooked for the younger players. The notable example is Creed Humphrey, who fits all my checks and has been one of the best Centers in the NFL since stepping on the field. While this class isn't flashy, there

are a handful of prospects who should be quality members of their line for many years. I value Guards a little more than Centers.

1. Joe Tippmann (#38)

Wisconsin – (6'6" 313 lbs)

My top center in the class, Joe Tippmann brings both experience and NFL upside. At 6'6" Tippmann is one of the taller center prospects in recent memory, which comes with some good and bad qualities. He is powerful with a strong base and the ability to seal blocks. Tippmann excels at gap blocking and takes smart angles at contact. He uses his length well, hitting defenders before they can get their hands on him. It's difficult for Tippmann to get low at his size, which loses some leverage battles. He has poor lateral flexibility and can get beat across his face. Tippmann is athletic with impressive range and quickness. He's not very agile and isn't a nimble blocker. He has decent footwork and identifies rushers well.

Tippmann's NFL physique and composure allows him to start immediately as a rookie. He's a capable pass blocker that will best fit a gap run scheme. His size struggles will affect him on the second level and hinders his flexibility, but he is a tough center to get around, who knows how to use his advantages well. Tippmann can be a long term starter and has the traits to bet on in the second round.

Strengths:

Length/Size

Experience/Composure/Football IQ

Gap Blocking

Strong Base

Weaknesses:

Getting Low/Leverage

Sloppy Second Level Blocking

Lateral Flexibility

Grade: Middle Second

2. John Michael Schmitz (#50)

Minnesota – (6'3" 301 lbs)

John Michael Schmitz is an experienced center with four years of productive blocking for Minnesota. Schmitz is a player you want leading your offensive line, identifying stunts and blitzes from the second level. He excels at building run lanes and has impressive awareness to switch between defenders. Schmitz is explosive off the line and locks defenders. His pass protection is consistent and polished, he's a safe bet to protect his quarterback immediately. Schmitz fills gaps and cuts off rushers. He had an impressive Senior Bowl week, practicing like one of the best blockers in Mobile.

John Michael Schmitz's weaknesses are obvious, as he's an older prospect who lacks many high end traits. At twenty fours years old, it's unlikely that Schmitz will get much better as a blocker and you're drafting him mainly on his college skills. He's a tad undersized and doesn't impose his power as a mover. Schmitz is agile but struggles to finish blocks on the second level. His testing was mediocre with a 7.86 RAS with none of his numbers standing out whatsoever. Teams looking for prospects with elite traits will pass on Schmitz for players like Joe Tippman or Luke Wypler. Schmitz is ready to run an offense, preferably in a gap run scheme where he thrived in college. He can be a solid pass protector immediately. His ceiling isn't anything special, but he has an extremely high floor.

Strengths:

Experience: Identifying Blitzers/Stunts

Consistent Pass Protection

Building Run Lanes

Weaknesses:

Not a Mover

Elite Traits

Age

Misses on Second Level

Grade: Mid/Late Second

3. O'Cyrus Torrence (#54)

Florida – (6'5" 330 lbs)

Following three years at Louisiana-Lafayette, O'Cyrus Torrence transferred to Florida and didn't allow a single sack or quarterback hit. He's a dense guard with a low center of gravity that wins him leverage battles. O'Cyrus is a mover in the run game that makes blocks on the second level. He is a smarter blocker who can execute complicated offensive line concepts and stungles. His hands placement is accurate and powerful, especially when securing double teams.

O'Cyrus isn't a great athlete and can get caught leaning on blocks. He takes bad angles on pass pro, giving up easier routes to the quarterback. O'Cyrus had a tough game against Jalen Carter, but that's more expected when facing arguably the best defender in the country. O'Cyrus had a disappointing combine, and his 23.5" vertical (16%) and 8.13 3-Cone (30%) will stand out for scouts. He was never touted as an elite athletic prospect, as his 5.98 RAS is indicative of his mediocre movement skills. O'Cyrus will have rookie issues to fix, but can grow into a quality guard. He's a long term guard option with a lower ceiling and a higher floor.

Strengths:

Mobility

Quick/Powerful Hands

Zone Runs

Weaknesses:

Leaning

Taking Angles

Grade: Late Second

4. Cody Mauch (#55)

NDSU – (6'5" 302 lbs)

Cody Mauch is hard to not fall in love with as a prospect. Originally committing to North Dakota State as a tight end, Mauch put on eighty pounds and converted to left

tackle. He has insane movement skills and gets in space to pancake defenders. Mauch is out for blood when he's blocking and finishes plays with intensity. He clearly kept some of his tight end athleticism, and proved that at the combine with a 5.09 forty (90%), a 4.55 shuttle (91%), and a 7.33 3-Cone (98%). His 9.87 RAS is a pure indicator of his special athletic abilities. While he played tackle at NDSU, Mauch length and build profiles as a pure NFL guard. He is a great zone blocker with plenty of experience and pulls well. Mauch has a quick release with solid footwork. Mauch uses his hand often, but is limited by his short arms. He's a sixth year senior that most likely has little room left to improve. Pass blocking isn't his specialty, but he is good enough for it not to be a problem. Any team looking for immediate run support, especially in zone runs, should look to Mauch. He has a high floor as a long term inside blocking option, just don't expect crazy growth at the position.

Strengths:

Agility

Zone Blocking

Second Level Blocking

Physicality

Weaknesses:

Short Arms

Lighter Guard

Age (6th Year Senior)

Grade: Late Second/Early Third

5. Andrew Vorhees (#59)

USC – (6'6" 310 lbs)

Andrew Vorhees is an experienced guard with the versatility to slide into any team. He's a tall lineman with a strong base. Vorhees is a physical blocker with active hands to attack defenders. His experience comes with polished instincts and pro-ready mirroring. Vorhees is a consistent blocker in both the passing and run game. He's not a special athlete and has trouble getting low. His poor flexibility opens defenders up to beat him across his face and win leverage.

Table Of Contents

As a 6th year senior, Vorhees is already twenty four and is one of the oldest prospects in the draft. He doesn't have a lot of potential for growth and is maxed out physically. His combine was disastrous as he tore his ACL during on field drills. The bright spot was Vorhees was able to bench press while supported by his one healthy leg. A true testament to his strength and grit, Vorhees put up an astonishing 38 reps on the bench, leading all IOL's for this year. He may get overlooked for some of the younger, more exciting prospects, but Vorhees has the consistency and versatility to be a long term starter. Practically any team can fit Vorhees into their scheme and plug him in once he recovers from his injury.

Strengths:

Consistent Pass Pro
Base and Length
Experience
Work Ethic

Weaknesses:

Second Level Blocking
Flexibility
Age (6th Year Senior)
ACL Tear

Grade: Late Second

6. Luke Wypler (#74)

Ohio St. – (6'3" 303 lbs)

Luke Wypler is a younger center who declared after two full seasons at center. He's a smaller center who's agile and works in space. Wypler is a fluid mover that gets to the second level quickly. He fills zone gaps and has especially impressive footwork for his age. Wypler takes smart angles and uses his hands successfully and often. Most of his issues stem from his mediocre strength and size. Wypler isn't a mover that will push the line. He has short 31½" arms and a limited radius for impact. Wypler can struggle to secure pulls and isn't fitting into a power run scheme.

Wypler should be drafted to a zone run scheme where he can utilize his agility to make blocks in open space. He is a capable pass protector with adequate technique and footwork. The big question with him is how he'll deal with the big NFL defensive tackles. He's a length and strength disadvantage and his base will get tested often. In the right scheme Wypler can be a solid starter. He's a backup/rotational center as a rookie.

Strengths:

Agility

Blocking Angles

Zone Blocking

Weaknesses:

Length

Not a Mover

Passable Strength

Scheme Dependent

Grade: Early Third

7. Steve Avila (#90)

TCU – (6'3" 332 lbs)

Steve Avila is a scheme specific guard with a clear skillset. Avila fortified TCU's line for Max Duggan, switching over from center to left guard for the first time. He is a burly lineman with impressive strength. Avila is a pure phone booth blocker with the blower to drive defenders back. He squares up and finishes blocks with his lower body force. With his power and thickness comes concerning slow movements. Avila has slow feet and can't make up any ground on missed blocker. His lateral movements are subpar and he will struggle to make open space blocks. Avila had trouble identifying blitzers from the second level, but will develop that skill over time. Avila is a gap scheme fit that isn't built for zone schemes and vertical attacks. He'll start out as a

Table Of Contents

backup that can progress into a rotational/fill in power blocker. Avila has special strength at the position, but lacks the movement skills of a premium guard prospect.

Strengths:

Impressive Strength

Size

Moves Defenders Back

Weaknesses:

Lateral Movements

Slow Feet

Identifying Blitzers

Grade: Late Third

Edge Rushers



When scouting Edge Rushers, the key component I look for is a consistent way to win. Whether it be a speed rush, power rush, hand usage etc., it's necessary for Edge Rushers to have a skill to rely on early in their career. I personally value Edge Rushers more than secondary defenders. While other positions value consistency and base level play, Edge Rusher is a role where high end skills are very important. Having a rusher that can take over a game is better than having one dominant Offensive Tackle, but having multiple consistent blockers is better than an overall solid DLine. With speed rushers, a common issue is play strength, and there are many prospects that should add mass early in their career. This is a fun Edge class with high level prospects and depth on day two.

1. Will Anderson (#1)

Alabama – (6'3" 253 lbs)

Will Anderson Jr. rightfully earns the top spot in my draft guide. He's completely dominated college football since his freshman season. Anderson was the best player in the nation last year, and while his numbers dipped, he continued his CFB reign. He's led the country in sacks the past two seasons with fifteen and fourteen. Anderson is extremely springy off the line, immediately generating massive power. He then converts that power to his hands, throwing lineman at will while using his phenomenal rip move and bull rush. It's practically useless to try and block Anderson with a running back. Anderson's athletically perfect as an edge, allowing him to bounce off blockers and collapse the pocket. He wins both inside and outside, while being a threat on stunt plays. Anderson's "lesser production" (still had insane stats") can be mostly attributed to constant double teams and chips.

Will Anderson is a blue chip talent, but what makes him even scarier as a prospect is that he still has room to grow. Anderson was consistently the most athletic player on the field and relied heavily on traits rather than pass moves. There's no doubt that he can develop his pass rush arsenal further, but he usually resorted to simply blowing by, or through, offensive tackles. Will Anderson won't be nearly as dominant as a rookie, but should still produce and is the front runner for DROY. He missed many tackles this season and needs to shore that up in the pros. Anderson has the skill and traits to be one of NFL's elite edge rusher's but must fully refine his pass rush arsenal to be grouped amongst T.J. Watt, Myles Garrett and the Bosa brothers.

Strengths:

Next Level Athletecism++

Rip Move

Shooting Gaps

Springy

Pursuit

Weaknesses:

Tackling

Usually Resorts to Athleticism Over Moves

More Refined Pass Rush Arsenal

Grade: Top Five

2. Tyree Wilson (#9)

Texas Tech – (6'6" 271 lbs)

Tyree Wilson's build resembles a Madden create-a-player. He's a monstrous 6'6 with insane 35 $\frac{1}{2}$ " arms. His 86" wingspan (Giannis Antetokounmpo's are 87" at 7'3") is the best in the edge class and is an immediate advantage as a rusher. He uses his powerful hands to attack with strength. Wilson's impressive swim move leads his array of active hand moves. He's an instant impact run defender. His range and length in run defense is coupled with Wilson's quick reaction to snuff out run plays. Tyree is an edge setter that gives full effort on every down.

With his massive frame, Tyree's get off is slow and he wins much more than power than speed. He lacks counters and was able to win reps without moves in college. Tyree's an older prospect than most of the other top edge prospects. Stronger tackles were able to lock on to Tyree, so his adjustment to NFL strength will take some time. Tyree's bendy for his size but isn't a go-to speed rusher.

Tyree Wilson has the frame to win as a pass rusher and will influence a passing game without racking up sacks. He'll be a force in run defense, and must improve his get off and quickness to ascend to an elite pass rusher. Few prospects have Wilson's measurables and athletic traits, along with the potential as a team's premium edge rusher.

Strengths:

Frame and Length+

Strong Hands

Run Defense+

Collapsing Pocket/Edge Setting

Effort

Weaknesses:

Get Off

Slow Rusher

Older Prospects

Grade: Top Fifteen

3. Lukas Van Ness (#11)

Iowa – (6'5" 272 lbs)

Lukas Van Ness may be the strongest edge in college football. Nicknamed “Hercules”, Van Ness uses his massive frame to generate power and collapse offensive lineman. He wins the edge with strength and has the best bull rush in the class, which he frequently uses. Lukas wins leverage battles and uses his hands well. He’s a rare case of a premium prospect who started only six games this season. Iowa tends to play seniors over RS sophomores, so it’s no reason for concern. Lukas held his own against Paris Johnson and can wreck the pocket even when he loses reps.

Van Ness has a special bull rush, but his game is one dimensional. He has limited bend and won’t speed rush around the edge. Van Ness lacks many other pass moves and has poor counters. He’ll rush head on nearly everyplay, allowing Tackles to adjust to his style. The adjustment to the stronger NFL tackles may be tough as he’s used to always being the strongest player on the field. Without an overwhelming power advantage he’ll have to adjust and grow his game. His combine was as impressive as expected, with an elite 4.598 40 (97%) and 9.38 RAS. He’s clearly an elite athlete with high end traits. Van Ness has a goto skill to rely on as he develops his pass rush. He’s a high effort pass rusher and is a great tackler. If Van Ness can learn to win as a speed rusher or technician he’ll be a pass rushing star in the NFL.

Strengths:

Powerful+
Bull Rush
Versatile
Frame/Build
Effort/Motor
Pocket Wrecker

Weaknesses:

Counters
Speed Moves
Bend
Pass Rush Arsenal

Grade: Top Twenty

3. Myles Murphy (#15)

Clemson – (6'5" 268 lbs)

Heralded as a premium prospect, Myles Murphy was an immediate contributor as a freshman. His next two years didn't quite live up to the hype, but Murphy was a significant part of Clemson's defense nonetheless. Murphy is a massive, bulky edge that fits the NFL mold. He has the full spectrum of athleticism, rushing with both speed and power. His bull rush is impressive and he collapses the pocket. Murphy is a high motor rusher with active hands. He disengages well and is slippery through blocks. Murphy was unable to test at the combine, but had a fantastic pro day. Murphy ran a 4.52 forty (99%) and recorded a 9.88 RAS. While these numbers aren't technically official, it gives a range to Murphy's athletic profile.

Murphy has an unteachable combination of speed and power, but hasn't tapped into his full ability. Murphy's lateral movements are stiff which leads to trouble chasing down quarterbacks and finishing plays. He has limited bend and doesn't play as much "pop" as he should. Murphy rushes upright, which limits his own power. Murphy can rush uncontrollably, another area for improvement. His low 14.3% win rate as a rusher (111th) is a clear sign that he's still growing as a player. Myles Murphy profiles as a day one starter who'll win with strength and help as a run defender. If he can refine his movement skills he'll be a powerful force on the edge. Murphy's floor is a low end starter with the potential of a disrupting pro bowl rusher.

Strengths:

Power

Massive Frame

Speed For Size

Weaknesses:

Stiffness

Lateral Speed

Uncontrolled Rush

Lack Of Elite Production

Grade: Top Twenty

5. Nolan Smith (#16)

Georgia – (6'2" 238 lbs)

Nolan Smith is a former top recruit who's been a consistent leader of Georgia's defense. He had a great 2021 season before unfortunately missing most of this year with an injury. In his few games this year, Nolan was exciting on tape. He's a much smaller and skinnier edge who looks more like a linebacker. Nolan is uber explosive and has the best twitch of any player in the draft. He "moves differently", slicing through gaps and bending around the edge with speed. Nolan's an athletic freak and makes lineman miss with his next level shiftiness. He knows how to use his strengths well against tackles and find the ball in the backfield. His football IQ is off the charts and he's a hard worker and a natural leader. As a speed rusher, Nolan has hand counters and can win the edge. He was able to rush 1v1 because of Georgia's stacked defensive line. Most of Nolan's issues stem from his size. He can be pushed around in the run game and will struggle to overpower strong NFL tackles. He'll be a true outlier as an edge and may be used in coverage and pursuit more than he did in college. If anyone can overcome his size questions it's Nolan, but it's harder to project a player with such a strength and frame disadvantage.

Missing most of the season, Nolan Smith needed a big combine performance to vault himself back into draft conversations. He exceeded all expectations with an otherworldly weekend that solidified his first round status. Nolan started with an all time jumping number, 41.5" vertical (99.8%) and 10'8 broad (98%). It's hard to find edge rushers more explosive than Nolan. He ran the fastest 10 yard split ever for an edge 1.47 while completing his ridiculous 4.39 40 (99.9%). To put into context how crazy his forty time is, Smith easily outpaced NFL stars DeAndre Hopkins and Stefon Diggs and would've placed 5th among receivers in this year's draft. Jalin Hyatt, the speedster of this year's class, ran a 4.40 forty.

Nolan Smith has the traits and work ethic to be a star in the NFL. His size disadvantage is his biggest hurdle to overcome, and he may play a different role than he did at Georgia. He's an immediate starter as a pursuit and rangy defender who can win pass sets. His ceiling is skyhigh as a versatile edge rusher.

Strengths:

Table Of Contents

Twitchy++

Instincts

Bend

Wins With Athleticism

Finds The Ball

Record Setting Combine

Weaknesses:

Injury/Limited 2022 Film

Frame

Pushed Around In Run Game

Relies On Traits

Grade: Top Twenty

6. Adetomiwa Adebawore (#32)

Northwestern – (6'2" 282 lbs)

I've been very high on Ade Adebawore for a while now, so it's nice to see consensus media come around. Ade is a wider edge who lines up in a four point stance. He was used all over the line at Northwestern. He's a high motor edge with the power to collapse the pocket. Ade uses his strength to bull rush, create angles and shoot gaps. He eats up space in run defense and has range to prevent outside runs. Ade is a shorter DL with nearly 34' arms, and his condensed build helps him win leverage battles. Ade has a strong rip move and two hand punch, but lacks counters.

Ade's biggest pass rush weakness is his stiffness. His lower body is fluid, but his upper body stiffness prevents him from winning outside. Ade's a better interior pass rusher, but is more effective at stopping the run from the outside. He performed very well against Ohio State and was a leader on Northwestern's defense.

His draft process rise has been astronomical, all starting at the Senior Bowl. He stood out as a top performer, overwhelming tackles with his powerful bull rush. Already moving up draft boards, Ade had the best performance of any prospect this year, placing him amongst the all time greats. He ran a ridiculous 4.49 40 (99%) and 1.55 10 yard split (99%) at a whopping 282 lbs. His 40 yard dash time was comparable to top receiver prospects such as Jordan Addison (4.49) and Rashee Rice (4.51), however Ade

Table Of Contents

weighs 110 pounds more than Addison and 80 more than Rashee Rice. Ade continued with a 37.5" vert and a 10'5" broad jump, both 95% amongst edge rushers. He proved himself as one of the freakiest athletes at edge (9.87 RAS) and may even go in the first round.

Ade is still scheme specific, with his interior pass rushing and edge run defense. His stiff upper body is still an issue, but his elite athletic traits give him a high ceiling as a rusher. He'll continue to develop his hand usage and counters in the NFL. He'll be a primary run defender as a rookie who can disrupt plays, and can grow into a premium DLine starter.

Strengths:

Versatility
Pocket Collapsing
Versatile Run Defender
High Motor
Senior Bowl Performance
Record Setting Combine

Weaknesses:

Bend/Stiff Upper Body
Winning Outside
Hand Counters
Finesse Moves

Grade: Early/Mid Second

7. Tuli Tuipulotu (#33)

USC – (6'3" 266 lbs)

Tuli Tuipulotu has been amongst my favorite overlooked prospects this year. The USC defender recorded 13 sacks (2nd in CFB) and 37 hurries (11th) while playing nearly every role for the Trojans. There were questions whether Tuli would play as an interior lineman, but he solidified his status as a pure edge by showing up at 266 lbs at the combine. His experience as an IDL allows teams to be flexible with his scheme positioning. Tuli is explosive off the line and shoots gaps in run defense. He wins with a

power/size combo and pure hustle and effort. He is a highly instinctual defender that understands his role on the field. Tuli rushed purely with traits, using a two hand bull rush, lacking counters and a deep pass rush arsenal. He's a rangy run defense that isn't a mover but sniffs out the ball. Tuli is a stiffer rusher and won't bend around the edge.

His most impressive traits are his effort, leadership and full spectrum of intangibles. He has the work ethic to fully round out and develop his game, even after producing a high level in college. Tuli lacks the flexibility of a first round edge, but gets himself involved in plays regardless. Tuli is a great swiss army knife rotational lineman who should eventually be a highly productive starter.

Strengths:

Explosion/Burst

Versatility

Intangibles+

Production

Weaknesses:

Pass Rush Moves

Bend/Stiffness

Tweener Size

Grade: Early/Mid Second

8. Felix Anudike-Uzomah (#37)

Kansas St. – (6'3" 255 lbs)

Felix Anudike-Uzomah is one of the higher floor pass rushers in the draft. He is backed up with a combined 21 sacks in the past two seasons. Kansas State lineup him up in both 3-4 and 4-3 sets. He wins with his hand moves, especially swipes and swim moves. FAU has a larger arsenal of moves than most draft prospects with a variety of push/pull moves. He has a stronger NFL build but gets shut down when he attempts to win with power. He'll fail to successfully bull rush and doesn't push the pocket. FAU didn't consistently disrupt the passing game. He has a solid get off but doesn't rely on quickness. Felix is a slippery run defender and successfully disengages from blocks. However, he's far from a mover and is a sloppy tackler. With proper refinement Felix

can be a solid pass rush technician. His ceiling is a multi sack edge defender, but he lacks the power to be a true star.

Strengths:

Shoots Gaps+

Hand Usage

Pass Rush Arsenal/Counters

Well rounded

Slippery

Weaknesses:

Pocket Pushing

Bull Rush

Collapsing in Run Game

Elite Athletic Traits

Grade: Middle Second

9. Isaiah Foskey (#44)

Notre Dame – (6’5” 264 lbs)

Isaiah Foskey has been a staple of Notre Dame’s defense for three seasons, capping it off with 12 sacks (4th in CFB) in 2022. Foskey is quick off the line and is relentless in his path to the quarterback. He packs power into his build, pushing the pocket even when he loses reps. Foskey is athletic enough to drop back. Foskey’s change of direction and patience is elite. He hasn’t found a way to consistently win reps and isn’t a true 1v1 winner. His hands lack “pop”, neutralizing his power rush attempts. Foskey’s inconsistent play strength shows up when he attempts to disengage blocks. He’s very instinctual and sniffs out run plays. Foskey lacked counters and is still refining his pass rush arsenal. His inability to frequently convert speed to power was especially evident against Ohio State, where he had an extremely quiet game.

Foskey is well rounded and has the athleticism to continue developing as a rusher, just may lack the overwhelming skill or trait to be a pass rush dominator. His Senior Bowl performance only reinforced this as he struggled in the 1v1 drills in practice. Foskey is a +athlete with natural instincts and a high motor. He needs to

Table Of Contents

utilize his speed better, but can already set the edge and push the pocket. Foskey is a solid 3-4 OLB Edge piece with plenty of room to grow.

Strengths:

Build

Versatility

Speed/Stamina/First Step

Hand Usage

Pocket Pusher

Football IQ

Weaknesses:

Not a True Pass Set Winner

Not a True 1v1 Winner

Power Rush

Speed To Power

Grade: Middle Second

10. B.J. Ojulari (#53)

LSU – (6'2" 248 lbs)

The brother of Azeez Ojulari, one of my favorite prospects, B.J. Ojulari is looking to be the next premium pass rusher in the family. He is a bendy speed rusher with a multiplicity off pass moves in his arsenal. Ojulari is a great tackler with patience and intelligence as a run defender. He's explosive on stunts and rushes with arguably the most diverse and polished pass rush plan in the class. While Ojulari possessed the pure skill to dominate college tackles, his lack of size and power allowed tackles to adjust and counter. He can be pushed around and be locked in by lineman with strong arms. His lengthy 34½" arms may help him evade that scenario altogether. Ojulari rushed head on, but lacked the strength to win with power. His overall pass rush repertoire gives him a high ceiling as a technician, but he simply failed to convert his moves to win in college. Ojulari will never be the dominant physical specimen and is at a disadvantage in an era where offensive lineman are more athletic than ever. If Ojulari

can convert his skill and explosiveness into power he can be a double digit sack rusher. If not, he's a high effort, smart rotational pass rusher.

Strengths:

Bend/Quickness

Pass Rush Arsenal

Motor/Effort

Can Win The Edge

Weaknesses:

Size

Pushed Around

Converting Moves To Wins

Power Rush

Grade: Late Second

II. Zach Harrison (#71)

Ohio St. – (6'5" 274 lbs)

At 6'5 274 lbs with record breaking 36½" arms, Zach Harrison has the perfect length for an edge rusher. His length is evident through a flurry of swipes and swim moves. He's quick with the explosiveness off the line to win the edge. Harrison has the traits to develop into a quality wide 9 pass rusher. Harrison's power is underwhelming given his size and didn't consistently collapse the pocket or wreak havoc in the backfield. He's stiff laterally, lacking the fluidity that all the top edge rushers possess. Harrison isn't yet a disrupter in run defense and could get pushed around. As a later day two edge, Harrison has the physical makeup that most edges don't have. It's easy to envision him as a 10+ sack player with his length and speed, but he must develop the natural feel of an edge rusher. Zach Harrison will start out as a rotational edge that can improve into a pass rush specialist.

Strengths:

Length

Quickness

Hand Usage

Weaknesses:

Power

Stiff

Power Run Defense

Grade: Early Third

12. Will McDonald (#79)

Iowa State – (6'3" 239 lbs)

Will McDonald has crept into first round conversations, but I'm more hesitant on the Iowa State rusher. McDonald is a long edge rusher with almost 35' arms. He is twitched up and can win the edge. He's a speed rusher off the edge with great range in pursuit. McDonald was misused as an inside rusher for plenty of the season and is too small to be an interior defender. He developed the versatility to drop back in coverage, with the change of direction to make plays on the ball. McDonald has the quickness to set the edge in the run game, but makes no impact as a power stopper.

McDonald is incredibly lean and could get pushed around by bigger tackles. He is a good tackler and is slippery through blocks, but won't be a consistent starter on run heavy downs. McDonald showed flashes of impressive pass set wins, but rarely used pass rush moves. He needs to develop a better arsenal that complements his freakish length. McDonald opted out of most combine testing, but jumped 11' in the broad (99%), reinforcing his explosive profile. McDonald must add mass to his frame, as every year talented pass rushers fail to make a difference due to their lack of functional strength. Hopefully being a full time edge rusher will speed up his pass rush development. McDonald is a pass play specialist as he increases his size and strength. He'll take time to adjust to NFL strength as a rookie, and should go relatively unnoticed, but has the potential to be a quality pass rusher.

Strengths:

Length

Twitch

Pass Rush Potential

Shoots Gaps

Weaknesses:

Lean at Edge

Power Run Defense

Raw- Few Pass Rush Moves

Inconsistency

Grade: Early Third

13. Keion White (#80)

Georgia Tech – (6'5" 285 lbs)

Keion White has been vaulting up draft boards, with appearances in the first round of mock drafts. While I understand the allure with Keion White, I'm much lower on him and think his profile has many concerns. White played both sides in high school, but committed to Old Dominion as a tight end, before switching to edge rusher and later transferring to Georgia Tech. He's a big edge with true NFL size and 34' arms. White's power profile is impressive with a strong bull rush and powerful hands. He's quick for his size and has the traits to win both inside and outside.

Keion White has the full spectrum of athletic potential, but is far from putting it all together. He has very few hand moves and generally rushes head on. His pass rush repertoire is sloppy and his lateral movement is clunky. White's bend is solid, but he must get lower to win leverage battles. He is inconsistent as a run defender and isn't as disruptive or powerful as you'd like from his size. Keion White is not an immediate contributor, but the concern multiplies once you acknowledge the fact that White is already 24 and will be 25 by the end of his rookie year. He's had plenty of reps at edge rusher and has failed to put his talent together.

White is a pure developmental pass rusher with the power and length to perform as an inside/outside winner. His potential as a run defender is obvious, but he needs to overcome his leverage and lateral movement issues. White has a high ceiling as a high sack rusher and run defender, but betting on an older, more experienced prospect who still has ways to go is a massive risk.

Strengths:

Size/Length

Power

Pass Rush Potential

Weaknesses:

Pass Rush Refinement

Sloppy Run Defense

Age

Grade: Middle Third

14. Andre Carter (#84)

Army – (6'6" 256 lbs)

After a dominant 2021 season, Andre Carter was one of the highest ranked edge rushers coming into this year. He failed to live up to expectations this year and finished the seasons with more questions than he started with. Carter immediately pops off the screen with his alien 6'6 build. His crazy length will intrigue coaches as they could develop him into a completely unique edge rusher. Carter is explosive off the line and shoots gaps. He has a great swim move and hand swipes. Carter lines up as a standup wide 9 rusher and projects there at the next level. He wins with the angles he creates by lining up so far wide. Carter can lose leverage due to his height and can be pushed to the outside. He's fluid laterally but not vertically.

As a run defender, Carter is slippery through blocks and has crazy length. However, he's often pushed around and is a poor tackler. His lack of muscle mass on his lengthy frame is evident as he can get manhandled when locked in. He had a poor Senior Bowl week and was dominated by Ohio State's Dawand Jones in 1v1's. Labeled as an athletic freak, Carter's combine performance was underwhelming. His jumps were atrocious and he failed to stand out in any of the drills. He recorded a 5.42 RAS, lowering his stock even further. Carter's physical training at Army is vastly different from the other prospects, and could've played a role in his testing numbers. It's much harder to add mass while at Army, as their training requires constant movement and emphasizes cardio.

Table Of Contents

Carter's length and explosive profile gives him a high ceiling at edge. He plays a weird wide 9 role that requires distance between him and the offensive tackle. His counters, angle and explosiveness all help him win reps, but his bend and leverage issues are tough to overcome. His inability to be a run game performer will limit his playing time early on. Carter is a true developmental pass rusher who needs time to acclimate to the NFL, but can be a truly unique pass rush contributor.

Strengths:

Length

Slippery/Angles

Good Counters

Hand Usage/Technician

Weaknesses:

Tackling

Leverage

Bend

Dropoff from 2022 to 2021

Senior Bowl/Combine

Grade: Middle Third

15. Dylan Horton (#87)

TCU – (6'4" 257 lbs)

Dylan Horton was a key defensive component for TCU's impressive run this season, amassing 10 sacks and 35 hurries. He rotated positions across their defensive line and looks to be a 4i interior lineman in the NFL. Horton is a motivated pass rusher, winning reps late in the play. His tight hips limit him from winning outside frequently. Horton wins inside with his hands and overall strength. He doesn't consistently win 1v1 reps, but has the athleticism and effort to improve as a pure pass rusher. His spin move was more successful, and Horton has solid counter moves in his repertoire. The offense gave extra attention to Horton, sending him constant double teams and chip blocks. While he has adequate speed for his size, Horton's release is average at best. He is functional as a run defender and gives the same effort he does in the passing game.

Table Of Contents

Dylan Horton has the athleticism and elite motor that teams will fall in love with, but he is still developing his pass rush skills. His late play wins are nice, but you'd like to see more wins at the point of contact. Horton is a 4i inside rusher who can be moved outside if needed. He's a year one rotational DL and can develop into a quality versatile pass rusher.

Strengths:

Outstanding Effort and Motor

Strong Hands

Good Counters

Versatile

Weaknesses:

Stiff Hips

Scheme Fit

Wins Reps Slowly

Grade: Middle Third

16. Mike Morris (#101)

Michigan – (6'5" 275 lbs)

Mike Morris was Michigan's premier edge rusher. Morris is a big, lengthy defender with the power to be a productive run defender. His release is quick off the line and he gives full effort every play. Morris can win the edge, which is impressive at his size, but struggles to win leverage battles. He doesn't convert speed to power frequently, and has limited pass rush moves. Morris dominated draft prospect Jaelyn Duncan, displaying his freakish 1.64 10 yard split (98%) on tape. His explosion is underwhelming as he rushes upright. Morris will rely on his length as a rookie while he develops pass rush moves. He's a project rusher who can become especially impactful as a run defender.

Strengths:

Length

Table Of Contents

Can Win Edge
Release With Size
Run Game Potential

Weaknesses:

Doesn't Convert Speed To Power
Pass Rush Arsenal
Loses Leverage

Grade: Early Fourth

17. Derick Hall (#106)

Auburn – (6'3" 254 lbs)

Hall is an early day three pick with the traits to stick on a defense. He is a smaller edge with an unorthodox build. Hall is quick off the line and converts speed to power. Hall's a good tackler and has range on zone run plays. He has absurd 34½ inch arms which he used to win reps at the Senior Bowl. Hall has the athleticism and burst to be a high energy pass rusher, but didn't consistently win reps in college. He has limited bend and his technique and hand use is far from polished.

Hall was boxed by premier tackle Olu Fashanu which opened up concerns to how he'll face against the better NFL tackles. Hall doesn't collapse blockers in run defense and is undersized as a power defender. With traits to dominate college football, Hall never took the jump to an elite defender. He profiles as a solid rotational EDGE with athleticism and juice. He'll struggle to consistently win pass sets but can improve if he refines his speed to power moves. Hall isn't an early down rusher and has potential to be a productive "swing edge".

Strengths:

Speed To Power
Tackling
Juice
Arm Length

Weaknesses:

Limited Counters and Hand Moves

Run Defense

Lacks a Way To Win

Grade: Fourth

18. Nick Hampton (#107)

Appalachian St. – (6'2" 236 lbs)

Nick Hampton is a productive edge rusher with a way to win pass sets. He's very twitchy off the line and wins the edge with speed and elite bend. Hampton has long arms which he utilizes in a clean rip move. He's quick in pursuit with the agility to chase down opposing quarterbacks. He produced at Appalachian State and had a fantastic Senior Bowl week. Hampton has the movement skills to drop back as a standup 4-3 OLB.

Hampton's big flaw is his size and strength which he must improve on to be a quality NFL starter. He has a very thin frame and is stopped when attempting inside moves. Hampton puts in effort as a fun defender, but is too light to make an impact. He has virtually no power moves in his arsenal and can get pushed around the edge by powerful tackles. His game consists of a pure speed rush profile and his one dimensional skill set limits him at the NFL level. Hampton is a classic thin, explosive speed rusher. If Hampton can add mass to his frame he'll be a quality pass rusher who specializes on passing downs. He'll be a backup as a rookie while he adjusts to the strength difference.

Strengths:

Speed Rush

Bend/Twitch

Pursuit

Explosiveness

Weaknesses:

Thin Frame

Table Of Contents

Functional Strength

Run Defense

Power Rush

Grade: Fourth

19. Isaiah McGuire (#111)

Missouri – (6'4" 268 lbs)

Isaiah McGuire is a safe mid round selection. He wins with hand placement and swipes. McGuire has speed to win reps off the edge and is relentless in getting to the quarterback. He's a decently well rounded athlete, but isn't overly bendy or powerful. His skillset can fit many different roles, but he lacks a trait or skill to scare opposing blockers. McGuire is better in run defense and can drop back in coverage if needed. His jumps at the combine were exceptional with a 36.5 vertical (91%) and a 9.50 RAS.

McGuire is a high effort defender who is a valuable rotational addition. He won't be an extremely dominant pass rusher, but will help stop the run and produce as a technician. McGuire's minutes will heavily increase if he improves his power.

Strengths:

Hand Placement

Run Defense

Effort

Weaknesses:

Strength

Bend

Grade: Later Fourth

Defensive Line



Defensive Tackles are increasing in value, with teams looking for a player who can both stop the run and impact the Quarterback. There's a few key elements I look for when scouting Defensive Linemen. First, I see if the prospect has an outstanding trait that will stand him apart. DLine is a position where it's harder to distinguish between players, and a majority of them are more easily replaceable than other positions. I check if the prospect either wins 1v1 pass rush sets frequently, or is an impactful run defender. Play strength is another important aspect as NFL trenches are a big step up in both size and strength. There are many NFL level athletes who torch CFB with pure size and power. Those players often find themselves struggling early on, as they can no longer purely rely on physical traits to dominate. This is why high level prospects like Quinnen Williams, Derrick Brown and Jeffery Simmons take a bit longer to break out. This is a great Defensive Line class with elite talent at the top and nine players graded in the first three rounds. This group has something for every team, so make sure to check out the scheme fits and role for each prospect.

1. Jalen Carter (#2)

Georgia – (6'3" 314 lbs)

On a Georgia defense stacked with elite talent such as Devonte Wyatt, Jordan Davis and Quay Walker, Jalen Carter was the best performer on his stellar team. Carter backed up a dominant 2021 season with an even more impressive 2022 campaign, posting a 92.3 PFF grade and a 16.3% pass rush win rate.

Jalen Carter moves with the explosiveness of an Edge, but with the power of a Nose Tackle. He bursts off the line and is crazy powerful at contact. Carter can collapse a pocket while also possessing bend to win with his quick swim move. Carter also uses the rip move where he utilizes his grown man strength. As a run defender he eats up space and shoots gaps. He was doubled a lot and still managed to affect plays.

Carter was able to win with pure athletic prowess, and relied on it too much at times. He repeats his successful bull rush multiple times, which NFL lineman will counter much easier. Carter needs to be more active with his hands and rushes with a high pad level that can prevent him from getting leverage. He can run sloppy reps and rely purely on power, and he must hone his technique to perform amongst the great interior rushers.

Jalen Carter was recently arrested for taking part in a street race that ended horribly. His legal status is currently undecided and teams may back off Carter until the case becomes clear. There are some off field character concerns with Carter, but I didn't drop his grade without a full understanding of the case and its repercussions. He showed up overweight to his pro day and looked out of shape during the drills, but it's likely that Carter wasn't able to fully prepare as he was dealing with his other issues. It's hard to judge Carter's off field issues without interviews, medicals and full knowledge of the arrest. I noted his concerns below, but am not dropping his overall draft grade as a result.

Carter's combination of strength, bend and burst will allow him to succeed early on as a rookie. He has technical errors and sloppy plays, but everything with Carter is coachable. If he can refine his technique and pass rush arsenal, Carter's potential is unlimited as a dominant run defender and pass rusher.

Strengths:

Complete Physical Profile++

Swim/Rip Move

Table Of Contents

Versatility

Collapses Pocket

Space Eater In Run Defense

Weaknesses:

Relied on Traits Too Frequently

Undisciplined Rushing

Pad Level/Upright Rushing

Off Field Issues

Grade: Top Five (Lower With Off Field)

2. Bryan Bresee (#6)

Clemson – (6'5" 298 lbs)

I'm extremely hopeful for Bryan Bresse after an unfortunate and underwhelming college career. He was the top recruit in his class and had high expectations going into Clemson. Bresee missed most of 2021 with an ACL tear and dealt with a shoulder injury this season. He also dealt with extreme family issues this past year that may have rightfully affected his on field performance.

His status as a top recruit is obvious, as Bresee has the size and athletic profile you rarely see in a DT. He moves more like an Edge than an interior rusher, with a super quick get off and first step. Bresee occasionally lined up on the edge and has the talent to do that in the NFL. He is still developing moves and won mostly off pure traits alone. Bresee has traits that are beyond uncoachable and his ceiling as a pass rusher is sky high.

He isn't a traditional interior lineman and shouldn't be used as a 2gapper or power run defender. Bresee is quick enough and has the reach to defend zone runs but can get moved by power runs. He rushes upright and needs to lower his pad level. Bresee lacked the production of an elite prospect and was consistent during his time at Clemson. Between injuries and off field issues he was never fully able to get into a rhythm and perform at his highest. Bresee dominated against North Carolina, a formidable team in a big game, with five pressures while showing signs of what he missed during his career. His health is a big concern, but Bresee's work ethic is encouraging for his growth as a prospect.

Table Of Contents

Bryan Bresee was in need of a big combine and absolutely produced. He looked like the best player on the field during every on field drill and ran a 4.89 40 (96%) and scored a 9.07 RAS (90%). He's still developing as a pass rusher, but he can win on pure traits alone while he builds the rest of his game. Bresee is a rookie starter who should be moved along the line and has limitless potential. The best is yet to come for Bresee.

Strengths:

Unique Athleticism

DE build, frame and length

Pass Rush Potential

Release/First Step

Pass Rush Potential

Edge Versatility

Weaknesses:

Power Run Defense

Pad Level

Refined Pass Rush Arsenal

Pocket Collapsing

Health/College Consistency

Grade: Top Twelve

3. Calijah Kancey (#34)

Pitt – (6'1" 281 lbs)

Pitt's Calijah Kancey draws comparisons to former Pitt star Aaron Donald with his high production at a small size. Kancey isn't quite the prospect Donald was, but has his own unique strengths at the position. At 6'1" 281, Kancey will be one of the smallest interior rushers in the last 20 years. He also has 30% arms, another outlier for defensive tackle. His size isn't only a negative and gives Kancey many special skills. He has a lightning quick step and moves extremely well. Kancey wins with his hands, using quick rip moves and counters. His pure skill as a push rusher is amongst the top in the class, using angles, bend and leverage (easy to get leverage at short height) to win reps. Kancey's production this year was outstanding with 47 pressures, 8 sacks and

an elite 91.8 PFF grade. Kancey has the talent to rush off the edge by converting speed to power, but is too much of a tweener to switch there full time.

In the run game, Kancey holds his ground and detaches well, but his size is a massive disadvantage. He is stopped against double teams completely and is far from a traditional 2gapper. Kancey often loses once locked up and is more reliable as a rangy run stopper. He opted out of all combine testing besides the 40 yard dash, but ran a ridiculous 4.67 40 (99%), a time most other DLine prospects can't even imagine.

Calijah Kancey has the talent and production to be a premier rusher, but must overcome the glaring size and length disadvantage that makes his NFL translation difficult. He will have trouble as a power run defender, but has the range to get outside and stop outside runs. Kancey is a day one starter on pass sets, and can become a uniquely valuable pass rusher.

Strengths:

Multiple Ways to Win Pass Sets

Explosive/Bendy/First Step

Great Hands

Speed

Weaknesses:

Size/Length

Run Stuffing

Run Game Anchor

Grade: Early/Mid Second

✚. Keanu Benton (#36)

Wisconsin – (6'4" 309 lbs)

Keanu Benton is one of the biggest risers from the pre-draft process. Benton is a wide defensive lineman who's agile off the line with quick release. He's a great run defender that gets into gaps and finds the ball. As a pass rusher, Benton wins with his strong, violent hands. He lacks an effective bull rush and doesn't have a ton of "pop". Benton doesn't get too low due to his lack of bend and is a lateral space winner instead of a pocket pusher.

Benton showed up to Mobile and had an outstanding Senior Bowl week. He consistently won with burst off the line and his impressive hand usage, clearing up questions on his pass rush. Benton split time between rushing from the A and B gap at Wisconsin and has the versatility to play both in the NFL. His hand usage gives him a goto ability as a rookie, a skill that most rookies don't possess. Benton can start day one as a good run defender with solid pass rush skills. His bend and pure power limit his pass rush upside, but he can be a quality start with great run defense.

Strengths:

Quick/Violent Hands
Run Defense (Especially Gaps)
Agility

Weaknesses:

Explosive Power
Bend/Leverage
Bull Rush

Grade: Middle Second

5. Mazi Smith (#46)

Michigan – (6'3" 323 lbs)

Mazi Smith is an absolute athletic phenom. The #1 player on Bruce Feldman's "Freaks List", Mazi has a unique blend of strength and speed. He didn't test at the combine, but reportedly benched 22 reps of 325 lbs, jumped a 44" vertical and 9'4" broad, a 6.95 3-Cone and a 4.41 Shuttle. These numbers can't be officially confirmed, but videos came out of Mazi performing some insane physical drills.

His speed was obvious on tape, with elite quickness for his size and the ability to win off his first step. Mazi has intensely strong arms that he used to win with a rip move. His upper body strength overall is impressive and gives a lot to work with.

However, his power run defense was disappointing, and he was moved and occasionally redirected as a run defender. He played "defensive" and allowed blockers to approach him on power runs. His bull rush was disappointing for his strength, but

Table Of Contents

he showed a strong base. Mazi's flexibility allowed him to take quality angles and fit gaps.

Mazi used his elite traits to win 1v1's, but wasn't a successful run defender considering his size. His athleticism gives him a high ceiling as an interior rusher who will most likely be a 3-Tech with potential as a Nose Tackle. Mazi is a rotational starter as a rookie.

Strengths:

Strong Arms+

Speed

Traits

Explosiveness

Rip Move

Weaknesses:

Underwhelming Lower Body Strength

Redirected in Run Game

Bull Rush

Grade: Mid/Late Second

6. Siaki Ika (#61)

Baylor – (6'3" 335 lbs)

Siaki Ika is a monstrous Nose Tackle. He is a traditional run stuffer that eats up gaps and is fed double teams consistently. Ika stands his ground against nearly anyone and can take on multiple blockers at once. Ika has surprising juice for his size and a fast get off. He has potential as a slippery pass rusher but wasn't able to win consistent 1v1 reps in college. Siaki rarely used pass rush moves and doesn't properly gain leverage to win pass sets with power. From a massive Nose Tackle, Siaki doesn't pocket push as much as I'd like to see, usually resorting to keeping his position.

He came in 20 pounds lighter than expected at the Combine but had an unfortunate showing. Nose Tackles usually struggle at the Combine and Ika posted an underwhelming 2.02 RAS (20%). While he wasn't expected to test super well, the fact that he dropped twenty pounds and still tested poorly is a bad sign and dropped his

grade. His role as a run stuffing Nose isn't an incredibly valued position, so it's tough to predict where he will go in the draft. He's more of a one dimensional defender at the moment, so many teams won't put Siaki on their board. Siaki profiles as a day one run stuffer with a lot of room to grow in both the run and pass game.

Strengths:

2-Gapping

Size

Double Teams

Movement for Size

Pass Rush Potential

Weaknesses:

Leverage

Pass Rush Moves

Current Pass Rush Impact

Pocket Pushing for Size

Combine Performance

Positional Value

Grade: Late Second

7. Moro Ojomo (#76)

Texas – (6'3" 293 lbs)

Moro Ojomo was moved all around the line at Texas, but projects best as a 3-Tech. As a lighter IDL, Ojomo has a quick release and first step. He is explosive but isn't a power mover, and often uses a successful rip move to beat lineman. The leader of his defense, Ojomo led by example with his high effort and motor. He isn't a massive run stuffer, but holds his ground and has the movement skills to contain the edge. He's patient against the run and is always moving. Ojomo isn't designed to take on double teams and is best roaming the edge for stretch runs. He has juice to win as a pass rusher, but is still refining his moves to become a premium pass rusher.

Moro Ojomo is a smart DL with good athletic traits and elite intangibles. He had an impressive Combine, posting a 8.79 RAS (87%). His pass rush technique needs

refining, but Ojomo has promising tools. He had great production in college with a 16.3 win rate this season (7th in CFB) and an 84.1 PFF pass rush grade. Ojomo is a day one rotational 3-Tech who can progress into a solid starter, with the intangibles to bet on.

Strengths:

Quickness

Motor

Pass Rush Potential

Range in Run Game

Intangibles: Cerebral/Patient/Leader

Weaknesses:

Pass Rush Refinement

Run Stuffing

Double Team Technique

Not a Mover/Collapser

Grade: Early/Middle Third

8. Zacch Pickens (#85)

South Carolina – (6'4" 291 lbs)

Zacch Pickens is another quality day two selection for a team looking to bolster their pass rush. Pickens has a very quick first step and fast hands, which he uses to win pass sets at the line of scrimmage. As a finesse rusher, he has good movement skills and occasionally showed impressive hand usage. Pickens has the technique to block shed, but lacks the play strength and pure mass to be a pocket collapser. He lacked "pop" on contact and failed to win with his bull rush.

Pickens has the frame, length and athleticism to become a quality pass rusher, but his film was inconsistent and he must learn to utilize his traits better when attacking the quarterback. His 4.89 40 (94%), 9'8" (97%) broad jump and overall 9.89 RAS reinforced his explosive traits, but it won't matter if he can't translate them to gameday. Pickens has the quickness and hand skills that most rookie DT's lack at 3-tech and can grow into a solid well rounded starter on the defensive line. As a rookie, Pickens will most likely be a backup/rotational defender

Strengths:

First Step

Quick Hands

Athletic Pass Rush Potential

Weaknesses:

Inconsistency

“Pop”

Play Strength

Grade: Middle Third

9. Jaquelin Roy (#86)

LSU – (6’3” 305 lbs)

Jaquelin Roy is quite literally the tale of two halves as a prospect. Splitting Jaquelin between his upper and lower body brings two completely different draft profiles. Jaquelin thrives as pass rusher, with a quick upper body which he converts into a successful swim move. He is agile side to side and can convert speed to power. Jaquelin contorts his body to create slippery angles which he penetrates through. He’s a fast pass rusher that has the quickness to make plays in the backfield and succeed on stunts.

Jaquelin’s lower body presents his deficiencies as a 3-Tech, as he can get moved off the line. He lacks the lower body strengths to be a mover, and resorts to attacking upright, where he gives up leverage. Roy lacks the refined pass rush arsenal to overcome his lack of play strength, but was working on his pass moves throughout the season.

His talented upper body strength, which he uses to win with agility, quickness, angles and his swim move, is left mostly undeveloped if he cannot gain lower body strength. While he wasn’t great as a run defender, Roy has the potential to make backfield plays. Jaquelin profiles as a rotational DT, who can develop into a quality starting pass rusher (speed to power) with an enhanced lower body.

Strengths:

Agility/Quickness

Swim Move

Body Contortion- Creating Angles

Weaknesses:

Lower Body Strength

Moved in Run Game

Rushes Upright

Grade: Middle Third

10. Gervon Dexter (#103)

Florida – (6'6" 310 lbs)

My final interior prospect, I'm much lower on Gervon Dexter than consensus scouts. He had an all around elite combine performance, receiving the second best IDL grade this year with a 9.21 RAS (92%). His combine performance should mirror film off Dexter winning with traits and explosiveness, but this is far from the reality of his film. He has an average get off and waits to use moves, if he uses any moves at all. While he's good at disengaging from lineman he takes poor leverage and isn't very explosive at attack. Dexter's bull rush is inconsistent and wasn't a dominant pocket pusher on run plays. Overall on tape, everything with Dexter felt slower than it should have.

He has some redeeming traits, especially his strong arms which he uses to his advantage. Dexter showed lateral quickness on tape and the slippery ability to create and take angles. He's an experienced prospect and it shows on tape, with his ability to scan the field and find the ball.

Gervon Dexter is experienced enough to slide into an NFL team. He can disengage well enough to occasionally shake up the backfield, but is incredibly inconsistent down to down. His combine performance was encouraging, but he seemingly reads plays before reacting to them. There isn't a ton to be excited about Gervon on tape, but his combine and football intelligence will help him crack the rotation.

Table Of Contents

Strengths:

Strong Arms

Disengaging

Experienced/Football IQ

Combine Performance

Weaknesses:

Play Speed

Inconsistent Bull Rush

Inconsistent Pocket Pusher

Weak Run Defense

Grade: Early Fourth

Linebacker



The Linebacker position has clearly been a tough position to evaluate, with plenty of recent busts and overdrafts in the first and second rounds. Linebackers are seen as more of a defensive luxury than a premium position to build around. I think one of the biggest reasons teams have failed to scout linebackers in the past few years is the heavy emphasis on athleticism over pure skill. Athleticism is clearly an important trait for LB's as they need to roam the field and cover Running Backs, Receivers and Tight Ends. However, while uber athletic LB's dominate college and create big plays at the line of scrimmage, many of them lack the instincts and refinement to succeed in the NFL. The NFL is a league full of elite athletes, and the emphasis then turns to how well a player understands and can properly perform his role. Offensive coordinators can expose raw Linebackers in coverage, making instincts all the more valuable. Within traits, speed is a key component, but fluidity to change hips and keep up with routes is just as necessary.

Another important aspect is possessing a true role, or fitting into a specific scheme. Coaches have failed to properly use “chess piece” Linebackers and it's better for a prospect to thrive in one specific aspect than be passable in multiple roles. This

year's Linebacker class is underwhelming, and there's been tons of debate at the top. Modern NFL schemes have placed an emphasis on Linebackers lining up at edge and rushing the Quarterback, and there are many prospects designed just for that.

1. Jack Campbell (#31)

Iowa – (6'4" 250 lbs)

The leader of Iowa's defense, Jack Campbell was stellar this season. He received an outstanding 91.7 PFF grade (highest for all LB's), while allowing only 236 coverage yards. He received the Dick Butkus award for best linebacker, and any team that drafts based on production will have Campbell highly rated. Campbell has great instincts in both run and pass coverage, with the ability to find the ball. He is a good tackler with good effort and motor. He also disengages well and has the power to blitz.

Campbell is a bulkier old school LB and lacks high end speed or athleticism on tape. His movement skills, twitch and change of direction were inconsistent on tape and were his biggest weakness in his profile. But Campbell absolutely demolished all expectations at the combine, testing well in every category and scoring an insane 9.98 RAS (99% athlete). While it can't answer all the questions on tape, it made it clear that Campbell will have no issues holding up against top NFL talent. He's experienced and an older prospect, and will have no issues stepping in immediately as a rookie.

Campbell has the talent to be a prototype "old school" linebacker. He will instantly impact the run game and make downhill plays. He'll win with pure skill and instincts, but isn't the freak athlete teams covet nowadays, even if his combine said otherwise. While he lacks the ceiling of some other prospects, he is NFL ready with a role to play.

Strengths:

Run Defense+

Motor

Instincts

Leader

Combine Testing

Weaknesses:

Man Coverage

Table Of Contents

Vertical Speed

Twitch

Grade: Early Second

2. Drew Sanders (#41)

Arkansas – (6'4" 235 lbs)

A five star recruit out of Texas, Drew Sanders wasted two years on a stacked roster before transferring to Arkansas. He is a sensational athlete, who played nearly every role. As a Linebacker, Sanders is a fluid mover with the range to blow up sideline run plays. He is disciplined and has the instincts to fill run gaps and find the ball. Sanders relied on twitch more than pure strength as a defender, and was an inconsistent tackler (22 missed tackles). His run defense is his biggest strength, and contribute in that area immediately. Sanders' versatile athleticism allows him to be a successful edge rusher, which he will take snaps at in the NFL. However, he lacks the brute strength to consistently win edge reps in the pros and must either bulk up or purely resort to speed rushing. His strength is also evident as a downhill force, where he isn't a natural mover. Sanders has solid coverage instincts, but rarely took pure drop back snaps, and will need further experience in the role. Sanders profiles as a run defending LB with the instincts to improve as a coverage backer. He should get occasional EDGE snaps as well. As a rookie Sanders should be used in run defense and QB spy roles as he continues to polish his coverage skills.

Strengths:

Run Defense

Play Speed

Fluid/Rangy

Instincts

Edge Rusher Versatility

Weaknesses:

Tackling

Not a Mover

Coverage Experience

Brute Power

Grade: Mid Second

3. Trenton Simpson (#49)

Clemson – (6'2" 235 lbs)

Trenton Simpson has the explosiveness and versatility that teams look for in a modern linebacker. He is quick and agile, with the burst to make plays in the backfield. Simpson played nearly every role in the box: dropping into coverage, blitzing, lining up as edge and spying the QB. He's most comfortable as a run defender, with the instincts to find the ball and breakdown concepts. Simpson has the physicality to line up on edge, but is too small to win with power. He has the speed (4.43 40) to win the edge. Like most athletic college Linebackers, Simpson was rarely used as a pure coverage back. He has the traits to succeed, but lacks the experience to be productive in coverage as a rookie. He's also not fluid enough to guard in man coverage.

Simpson is a jack of all trades Linebacker that will play in the box. While he doesn't have a singular trait to lean on as a rookie, he has the athleticism to grow into a great, well rounded Linebacker. His role as a rookie is a "find ball, get ball" SAM LB. NFL teams may struggle to properly utilize his skills. My biggest concern is that he won't develop a goto trump card. Drafting Simpson is betting on his traits over his current skill set.

Strengths:

Aggressiveness

Burst

Finds the Ball

Run Defense Instincts

Quickness

Weaknesses:

COD

Smaller Frame

Lacks a truly elite skill

Grade: Mid/Late Second

4. DeMarvion Overshown (#56)

Texas – (6'3" 230 lbs)

DeMarvion Overshown is the most underrated linebacker in the draft. He was originally recruited to the Longhorns as a Safety, which shows every time he steps on the field. Overshown has the range to prevent stretch runs, with the speed to cover in space. He has great instincts in both run and pass defense, and has the movement skills to cover in man.

Overshown has insane length at the position, with 32½ inch arms in addition to his 6'3" height. His length helps him cover space and break up passes, but his frame is very slender and Overshown must add muscle. He is a big hitter, but his play strength is weak and can struggle against blocks and missing tackles. His frame has tons of untapped muscle potential, but it may take him a few seasons to completely grow into his body. Overshown has the speed and bend to rush off the edge, but lacks downhill strength. He jumped 36.5" and 10'4" at the combine, while also running a 4.56 40, both numbers that displayed his explosiveness.

In a poor linebacker class, Overshown has the chance to be a long term starter. Most of his issues stem from his slender frame, so if he can add weight/muscle he can round out an impressive profile. As a stronger linebacker he is a +starter with versatility. If not, Overshown should still be a solid rotational starter.

Strengths:

Coverage Instincts

Fluid

Big Hitter

Rangy With Long Speed

Fluid

Weaknesses:

Skinny Build

NFL Physicality

Play Strength

Power Run Defense

Grade: Late Second/Early Third

5. Nick Herbig (#83)

Wisconsin – (6'2" 240 lbs)

Nick Herbig was listed as Wisconsin's linebacker, but took a majority of his snaps at edge rusher. He was extremely productive with 20 sacks and a 91 pass rush grade (PFF) over the past two seasons. Herbig is extremely undersized at edge and has only 31¼ inch arms. He's explosive on stunts and sheds blocks at will. Herbig has solid hand usage with chops and spin moves. He combines shifty pass moves and bull rushes to attack the quarterback. His tweener frame and below average bend make it difficult for Herbig to win the edge. He is a run defense liability on the line and gets pushed around. Herbig was productive against many of the top teams, but struggled against Ohio State. His effort and high work ethic may vault his draft stock further than expected.

Nick Herbig is ultimately one of the most confusing evaluations in the draft. He was very productive on the line and won in multiple different ways, but could end up severely undersized to play that role. Herbig has the instincts to develop into a solid off ball linebacker, but has little experience in that position. It's unfortunate that someone with his college career and talent is in this situation, but with Herbig's intangibles he's a player I'm willing to bet on in the third round. Herbig profiles as a project linebacker who is heavily utilized as a pass rusher.

Strengths:

Pass Rush Arsenal

Motor/Effort

Instinctual

Hand Usage

Production

Weaknesses:

Small At Edge

Raw At Linebacker

Bend

Run Defense at Edge

Grade: Middle Third

6. Daiyan Henley (#95)

Wash St. – (6'1" 225 lbs)

Daiyan Henley was originally a receiver at Nevada, before switching to Safety and transferring to Washington State. His newness at the position is obvious, as his overall technique is raw. Henley's stance is too wide and can run undisciplined and uncontrolled. Henley occasionally reacts slowly and is caught not moving on the field.

However, Henley has the athleticism and traits that will help him quickly accel at linebacker. He is a quick, explosive defender with downhill power. His background at receiver gave him unique fluidity. Henley's a good blitzler and tackle, who won mostly with his athletic ability. Henley performed well at the Senior Bowl, before recording an impressive 8.89 RAS and the Combine. Any team that drafts Henley is betting that his traits speed up his development process. His production this year showed signs of a further developed prospect, with 5 sacks and a 90.3 PFF tackling grade.

Daiyan Henley will improve quickly, but he's already an older prospect at 23. It's tough to draft a developmental player who is also older than most other prospects. His age drops his grade down as it's unlikely that Henley will be a heavy contributor before 24/25 at the earliest. Henley has potential to be a solid coverage back who also makes a difference as a run defender and blitzler. He should be a backup as a rookie and can grow into a solid starter or rotational edge/blitzler.

Strengths:

Pass Rush Arsenal

Motor/Effort

Instincts

Hand Usage

Production

Weaknesses:

Small for Edge

Table Of Contents

Raw Coverage

Bend

Edge Run Defense

Grade: Early Fourth

7. Dorian Williams (#100)

Tulane – (6'1" 228 lbs)

Dorian Williams is this year's forgotten Linebacker prospect. He's overlooked as a small school player who is not a freaky athlete. He has a very lanky build and can struggle to fight through blocks. His frame has a lot of untapped growth, so expect him to put on mass early on. He's not overly twitchy and isn't a downhill blitzer or occasional edge rusher. Dorian is a classic read and react Linebacker. He is patient and knows how to avoid blocks while keeping his eye on the running back. Williams can play the classic coverage role, and has the instinct and eyes to cover an area well. While he's solid in many classic LB skills, he lacks a true dominant ability. Dorian Williams is fluid but lacks the twitch and downhill power to be a physical force. His combine performance was better than expected, running a 4.49 40. He has the well rounded skill set, intelligence and special teams skills to keep him on a roster, but don't expect high end production.

Strengths:

Zone Coverage

Read and React

Weaknesses:

Power

Twitch

Fighting Through Blocks

Grade: Early Fourth

8. Noah Sewell (#110)

Oregon – (6'1" 246 lbs)

Noah Sewell, brother of Penei Sewell, is a burly prospect with straight line speed. He is strong and can fight through blocks with the power to win as a blitzer. Sewell plays the downhill LB role very well, but can do little else at the position. He is extremely stiff which limits his coverage skills. His instincts in zone are serviceable, but his movement skills will prevent him from ever dropping back. Sewell also falls for misdirection and can overcommit to fakes and play actions.

Sewell failed to live up to the high expectations this year, getting exposed on coverage and misdirection plays. He profiles as a hard hitting downhill LB who is a tone setter and blitzer. Similar to last year's Channing Tindall he should get snaps on designed "find the ball" plays. His role is extremely limited and won't be on many team's draft boards.

Strengths:

Power

Blitzing

Play Speed

Weaknesses:

Stiffness

Jittery

Man Coverage

Grade: Fourth

9. Owen Pappoe (#112)

Auburn – (6'0" 225 lbs)

The final player on my list, Owen Pappoe, is another combine riser. Pappoe's game is designed around his speed, which he proved by running a 4.39 40 (99%) while also jumping 10 '6 in the broad jump (95%). He scored a 9.23 RAS which could potentially push him into round two discussions. His performance came to no surprise, as on film his explosiveness is evident. He is insanely fast from sideline to sideline and has fluid

Table Of Contents

movements. His frame is much smaller for a LB, but Pappoe has long 31.75 inch arms. His size limits him when facing power and fighting through blocks. Pappoe's mental side needs improvement as well, as he is slow to read and react while falling to misdirection. He has big play potential but can't be trusted in coverage due to his tendency to be targeted by the offense. Pappoe is a natural leader who was the two time team captain at Auburn.

Owen Pappoe profiles as a developmental speed linebacker. He has the athleticism to become a potentially rangy coverage player, but immense amounts of work is needed to get there. He has the twitch to play as an outside run defender, but struggles to win reps with power. Pappoe will start as a backup and can be utilized as a rotational LB/QB Spy.

Strengths:

Range

Leadership

Wingspan

Quickness/Fluidity

Weaknesses:

Frame

Fighting Through Blocks

Read and React

Power Defense

Grade: Late Fourth

Cornerbacks



Cornerback is likely the best group in the class and is littered with high end athletes and sleeper prospects. A main part of corner scouting is noticing a prospect's instincts and mentality. Good corners are always on the attack and react to routes and cuts immediately. Cornerback might be a defensive position, but corners who can be on the offensive and threaten a receiver's routes tend to stand out on tape. This obviously needs to be combined with fluidity and quick change of direction skills, but when put together produces an uber sticky Cornerback. You can often judge a corner by the first few seconds of the play by watching them backpedal and flip their hips. Teams play a wide range of defensive schemes, so these prospects will be valued very differently.

1. Christian Gonzalez (#5)

Oregon – (6'1" 197 lbs)

Christian Gonzalez is one of the most athletic cornerbacks in NFL history. He has the full range of traits, starting with his prototype frame and 32" arm length. Gonzalez is insanely fluid and can stay with virtually any receiver. He is patient against

releases, but is physical in press man. His closing speed is also ridiculous and he thrives on pure fly routes. Transferring from Colorado this season, Gonzalez blanketed most receivers he faced and was rarely targeted, so it was tough to find many clips of Gonzalez attacking the ball. He needs to turn around quicker and his overall ball skills aren't quite there yet. Gonzalez has the traits to be a scary ball threat, he just needs to unlock that killer instinct. He wasn't as natural in off-man, as his athleticism wasn't as big of a trump card. Gonzalez isn't yet refined in zone, but gets across the field and tackles extremely well.

His combine performance was as expected, running a 4.38 forty, and jumping 41.5" in the vert and 11'1" in the broad, leading to a 9.94 RAS. Gonzalez has the rare physical tools to be a true #1 cornerback. He has the highest ceiling of any corner in the draft, which combines with his stellar production this year to establish Gonzalez as the top corner prospect in the draft. While he was practically lockdown this year, Gonzalez still needs refinement with off-man, ball skills and zone coverage to truly complete his game. He'll start as an outside press corner with the classic rookie tendencies with the ability to progress into an island cornerback.

Strengths:

Build

Athleticism

Press Man

Movement Skills

Rarely Targeted

Weaknesses:

Ball Skills

Zone Refinement

Off-Man Refinement

Grade: Top Fifteen

2. Devon Witherspoon (#8)

Illinois – (5'11" 181 lbs)

The best cornerback in college football this year, Devon Witherspoon recorded a CFB leading 92.5 PFF coverage grade while locking down receivers and delivering punishing hits. He ranked top five in forced incompletions, targeted passer rating, completion percentage and yards allowed per route. Witherspoon is incredibly physical, exploding plays in the backfield without fear. He's a fluid corner with the quickness and acceleration to close on contested catches. He can be over aggressive and bite on routes and cause penalties, but he is extremely sticky and will stay with receivers. His willingness and impact as a run defender is hard to come by and will wow coaches on tape.

Witherspoon has the best film of any corner, but his measurables are less than ideal, and are definitely far behind Christian Gonzalez. He's a skinnier corner, but has the physicality and experience (2nd most man snaps) to play outside. There's a chance that his frame pushes him to Nickel where he can play as well. Witherspoon is a day one starter as a man corner and hard hitting run defender (may struggle with over aggression), that should be a very good sticky cornerback. (Shades of Greg Newsome)

Strengths:

Fluidity/Athleticism

Mentality/Physicality

Big Hitter

Man Coverage

Weaknesses:

Overaggression- Penalties

Thin Frame - Bigger NFL Receivers

Occasionally Bites On Routes

Grade: Top Fifteen

3. Joey Porter Jr. (#14)

Penn State – (6'2" 193 lbs)

Joey Porter Sr. fell all the way to pick 73, but his son Joey Porter Jr. will likely not make it out of the first twenty picks. Porter is an extremely long corner with 98th percentile 34" arms and a 81" wingspan. He nearly always has an immediate advantage

Table Of Contents

at the line, using his arms to press receivers at the line. He's extremely physical and attacks receivers before they have the chance to respond. Porter is sticky on routes and is aggressive at the catch point. He'll help out as a run defender as a high effort defender with good tackling. Porter's main concern is his occasional stiffness and clunky direction changes. Receivers can take advantage of Porter's tendency to take outside leverage and manipulate him on in breaking routes. He can also react late at the catch point and needs to improve his overall instincts when the ball is in the air. Porter's combine performance quieted most athletic concerns with a stellar combine, posting a 9.70 RAS. His individual numbers weren't as outstanding, but are more impressive given Porter's size.

Joey Porter isn't ready to be an immediate off-man starter but is a perfect press man fit with adequate zone coverage instincts. Porter can lose ground with direct changes, but if he can improve his fluidity and catchpoint skills he'll be a true island #1 cornerback. Porter profiles as an immediate starter with rookie inconsistencies and a high ceiling.

Strengths:

Athletic

Sticky

Press Man/Hand Usage

Tackling

Weaknesses:

Stiff COD

Catch Pont

Off-Man Coverage

Grade: Top Twenty

+ Cam Smith (#22)

South Carolina – (6'1" 180 lbs)

Cam Smith isn't the prospect Jaycee Horn was, but follows in his footsteps as a first round cornerback. Cam Smith is a learn corner who can afford to add mass in the NFL. He's very twitchy, with a blend of burst, quickness and speed. He plays tight

coverage and has an attacking mentality. Smith changes direction fluidly and moves well all around the field. His mirroring and instincts are stout and will hold up in man coverage. Smith can be over aggressive at times, between biting out routes and getting called for physical penalties.

The rest of Cam Smith's issues stem from his size at 180 lbs. Cam has tremendous ball skills, but struggles to defend bigger receivers at the catch point. Lineman control him on blocks, preventing Smith from impacting as a run defender. Smith's tackling is a problem, with a high 16.3% missed tackle rate. Many corners have struggled to adapt to the NFL's strength and physicality, and Smith's frame will only hurt him. Many draft analysts scrutinized Smith's athleticism, but I never saw that on tape. Cam Smith validated my take with a dynamic 9.69 RAS. Smith dealt with a handful of minor injuries at South Carolina, which adds some more risk for a player of his size. Nonetheless, Smith is a high floor corner with the athleticism and man skills to start immediately in man coverage. He'll need to put on mass to guard bigger receivers and improve into a true CB1. Smith may struggle with penalties and biting on routes as a rookie. Overall, Cam Smith is a quality man corner who can develop into a premium outside cornerback.

Strengths:

Twitchy
Man Instincts
Tight Coverage
Combine Testing

Weaknesses:

Thin Build/Frame
Grabby/Penalties
Bigger NFL receiver
Fighting Through Blocks

Grade: Top Twenty Five

5. Jaylon Jones (#24)

Texas A&M – (6'2" 200 lbs)

Table Of Contents

Jaylon Jones continues to be the most underrated corner in the draft. He's a bigger, long corner that will withstand NFL physicality. Jones has fluid hips and direction changes. His combination of patience and physicality on routes is impressive. Texas A&M played Jones primarily as a Cover-3 boundary corner. He didn't press a ton in college, and whatever team drafts Jones should increase that number. Jaylon Jones starts in a low stance, but can be upright on breaks which can lead to him stumbling. He also can twist himself on routes and overcommit to routes. Most of those issues are fixable, and Jones has the acceleration to make up lost ground.

Jaylon Jones isn't poor in run defense and has trouble fighting through blocks. He has the willingness to find the ball but has plenty of room to grow. Jaylon Jones isn't a flashy corner and doesn't have highlight interceptions and pass breakups, but he's a well rounded corner with no big issues. He's a younger cornerback that is turning twenty one around draft day while still having three full years of playing experience. Jaylon Jones played 69 man coverage snaps and allowed only fifteen yards on two catches. His 4.57 forty yard dash is concerning, and Jones lacks the long speed of elite NFL cornerbacks. He isn't an otherworldly athlete, but Jaylon Jones has projectable traits, mentality and experience in both man and zone. He is a day one starter that will occasionally give up big plays as he continues his development, and can grow into a quality/pro bowl cornerback.

Strengths:

Acceleration/Change Of Speeds

Fluid

Balance Of Patience and Physicality

Experience

Weaknesses:

Overcommitting to Routes

Raw Run Defender

Upright Stance

Occasional Stumbling

Long Speed

Grade: Late First

6. Kelee Ringo (#26)

Georgia – (6'2" 207 lbs)

Kelee Ringo was one the most highly touted prospects his year, but his college career never quite lived up to expectations. Ringo is an elite athlete with long speed and twitch. Ringo's 4.36 (96%) forty yard dash allows him to close on routes. There's a ton to work with in Ringo, but he still needs a ton of refining as a corner. Ringo's press technique is raw and can bite on routes. Ringo turns his head around and loses sight of the receiver. His reaction is very slow and doesn't have the necessary corner instincts. Ringo's physical issue is his change of direction, which is clunky for a guy with his physical profile.

His athleticism made up for a ton of his mistakes in college, but it won't be the same in the NFL. Ringo has good ball skills and is aggressive in contested catch scenarios. He has the athletic potential to be an elite man cornerback and most of his mental and technical skills are fixable. It's concerning that Ringo never fully developed at Georgia, but he's one of the youngest prospects in the draft at only twenty years old. I'm less confident in Ringo to develop at cornerback than most other top prospects, but I think he can make the transition to safety if needed. Ringo has the build, range and ball skills to be a successful safety, and his change of discretion issues will be less of a concern.

Strengths:

Athletic+
Twitchy
Ball Skills
Potential Safety

Weaknesses:

COD
Footwork
Eyes Get Lost
Bites/Jumpy

Grade: Late First

7. Emmanuel Forbes (#39)

Miss St. – (6'1" 166 lbs)

Emmanuel Forbes has the instincts and ball skills of a quality outside corner, but his frame is a complete outlier for corner prospects. Forbes reacts well in zone and has the talent to start in a zone scheme immediately. He moves well, but isn't an elite, twitchy athlete. Weighing in at only 166 lbs, Forbes will be the lightest corner in the league by a good margin. His lower body is thinner than any corner prospect I've scouted. As much as Forbes tries to hide it, his size concerns show up on tape. Forbes is a disaster in run defense and gets stuck on blocks. He is an awful tackler that ball carriers will take advantage of. There are times when Forbes clearly avoids contact, which worries me as Forbes will face massive players in the NFL. He can get beat across his face and his man to man mirroring needs work.

Forbes isn't a true man corner, but has the complete skill package to play zone. Drafting Forbes is betting that his talent and college production can outweigh his physical limitations. There's virtually no precedent for a player of Forbes size, and the step up in physicality can destroy his career. Teams will direct runs his way if Forbes does not improve his run defending and tackling. He's one of the most talented corners in the class, and would be right in the top tier if he bulked up to normal weight. He'll be a rotational rookie his corner year and has a high skill floor as a zone defender.

Strengths:

Zone Instincts

Ball Skills

Mentality

Weaknesses:

Incredibly Small Build

Tackling/Run Defense

Man Mirroring

Grade: Middle Second

8. D.J. Turner (#40)

Michigan – (5'11" 178 lbs)

D.J Turner has elite speed that most corners can only dream of. He utilizes his track speed in zone coverage, where he has flawless range across the field. Turner has sharp zone instincts and reads and reacts to routes quickly. His small 5'11" 178 lbs frame is a limiting factor in man coverage. He has poor length on the boundary and isn't very handsy or physical with receivers. Turner is sloppy guarding double moves, and his reaction time can use improvement.

With Turner's movement skills and burst he can make up for most of his technical mistakes. He ran a ridiculous 4.26 40 (99%) and will instantly be one of the fastest players in the league. Turner may not have the refinement in man coverage, but he is comfortable and instinctual as a zone corner. He is a backend rookie starter in a zone scheme, who can develop into a quality CB2 with potential to improve as a man corner as well.

Strengths:

Speed
Zone Instincts
Press Experience
Athleticism

Weaknesses:

Length
Tackling
Man Coverage Polish
Double Moves

Grade: Middle Second

9. Deonte Banks (#43)

Maryland – (6'0" 197 lbs)

Deonte Banks was a lesser known corner prospect, before rising up draft boards all the way into the first round. Banks played outside corner at Maryland and has the build to continue that role. He's a quick reactor that opens his hips well and is extremely fluid. Banks has experience in zone coverage and reads the field well. Banks has the athleticism to play tight, sticky coverage, but tends to give receivers a ton of

cushion. He gives up angles, allowing receivers to manipulate his movements. Banks is beaten by release packages and gets his head turned. His effort is disappointing as a run defender, and virtually adds nothing in that realm.

There's big combine performances, then there's Deonte Banks' combine performance. Banks ran a speeding 4.35 40 (97%) with a 1.45 10 yard split (99%). His 42" vertical (99%) and 11"4 broad (99%) solidified his perfect 10 RAS. He has a perfect blend of physical traits, Banks just needs to convert that into a lockdown mentality. He can start as a zone corner. Banks isn't sticky enough to to be an alpha CB, but has high end CB2 potential.

Strengths:

Reactions

Fluid

Size

Athletic Testing

Weaknesses:

Gives Cushion

Allows Angles

Run Defense

Grade: Middle Second

10. Julius Brents (#57)

Kansas St. – (6'3" 198 lbs)

Julius Brents is a massive corner with a record breaking 82" wingspan and insane 34" arms. He has value as a run defender and can wrap up ball carriers. Brents is poised and understands when to hand off players in zone. His zone skills are impressive overall, making Brents the perfect fit to slide into a cover 3 team. Brents uses his length to feel routes and disrupt receivers. He has the length to be an elite press corner, but didn't show that on tape.

Brents' tape this year and his combine were two completely different stories. Highly athletic receivers beat him in man, and Brents didn't have the elite long speed to keep up. His movement skills looked average and he continued playing like a purely zone corner. However, Brents absolutely smashed the combine. Besides his length

already being in a tier of its own, Brents jumped 41.5” in the vert (98%) and 11’6 in the broad (99%). His 4.53 40 wasn’t special, but his 4.05 shuttle (90%) and 6.63 3-cone (97%) landed him a near perfect 9.99 RAS. It’s one thing to have an impressive combine, it’s another to have the fourth best statistical combine in the last 25 years. His testing doesn’t disregard his tape, but it suggests that there may have been a limiting factor on his play (scheme, comfort..). Cover 3 teams will jump at Brents as he’ll slide in as a rookie. Purely off film, Brents should have some issues at first acclimating to the fast pace NFL style, but if Brents can his combine run he could be a day two steal.

Strengths:

Run Game

Wingspan

Zone Instincts

Combine Performance

Weaknesses:

Man to Man

Press

Long Speed

Grade: Late Second/Early Third

ii. Clark Phillips (#68)

Utah – (5’9” 184 lbs)

Clark Phillips has been one of the highest producing corners in college football. Phillips was second in CFB with six interceptions, while manning up some of the top receivers in the nation like Jordan Addison. Phillips is a quick, short corner who played both slot and boundary. He’s extremely physical, sometimes even too physical, who may get called for penalties. Phillips was able to keep up with receivers and close on their routes. He’s instinctual in man coverage and has phenomenal ball skills, knocking the ball out of receivers arms.

Looking at Clark Phillips, it’s easy to see why he could fall in the draft. He’s extremely small at 5’9, slender at 184 lbs, and has very limiting 29” arms. No team will play him outside with those measurables. His combine dropped him down boards with

a 4.53 40 and 33" vertical. His lack of explosiveness makes his frame even more worrying. He is forced to overcompensate with his aggressiveness to guard athletic receivers. Phillips is practically useless as a run defender and has trouble fighting through blocks. His tackling is concerning and bigger players will have an advantage with the ball in their hands. Clark Phillips is one of the more talented corners in the draft, but his measurables completely change his NFL role. Once seen as a potential outside/inside corner, Clark will purely be a slot defender. He can be a solid starting corner with rookie struggles who compares most similarly to last year's Roger McCreary.

Strengths:

Quickness

Instinctual

Ball Skills

Aggressive

Weaknesses:

Size/Frame

Overcommits/Grabby

Awful Tackler

Terrible Combine

Grade: Early Third

12. Kyu Blu Kelly (#70)

Stanford – (6'0" 191 lbs)

Kyu Blu Kelly is a quality corner pickup on day two, as one of the fewer prospects who have potential as an outside starter. Kelly is a smart defender with plenty of experience. He has good ball skills, turning to the football, and plays the sideline well, where he is most comfortable playing with outside leverage. Kelly's fluid laterally and can make up short ground with quickness. His build and overall traits on tape resemble a starting corner, but he has plenty of issues to refine. Kelly must play more active and less reactive, especially when covering release packages. He needs to use his hands more in press and isn't as comfortable in off-man. Kelly's vertical change

Table Of Contents

of directions is clunky which compounds with his tendency to bite on double moves and stop and go routes. Kelly had an impressive Senior Bowl week and was one of the top corners in attendance. He's by no means close to a finished product, but most of Kelly's technical issues are fixable, especially in off-man coverage. Kelly will start as a rotational outside corner, with the traits to develop into a comfortable boundary CB2, who'll most likely end up as a quality backend cornerback starter.

Strengths:

Athletic Traits

Ball skills

Good Eyes

Weaknesses:

Vertical COD

Reactionary in Man

LOS Release

Grade: Early/Middle Third

13. Eli Ricks (#91)

Alabama – (6'2" 188 lbs)

As a freshman at LSU, Eli Ricks was phenomenal, receiving All-American honors and known as a top ten player in his draft class. His following season at LSU was disappointing, before transferring to Alabama and only starting the last four games of the season. Ricks is a lanky corner with 32½" arms. He uses his length to efficiently disrupt routes. Rick is a high intensity corner that puts effort into the run game, even if he doesn't affect it very much. Ricks is composed with smart route instincts.

Outside of his length, Eli Ricks lacks elite traits. He isn't a speedster and can be challenged by fast NFL receivers. He's flat footed and can overcommit to double moves and fakes. His hips aren't extremely fluid; Ricks isn't a corner you want on an island. He's missed meaningful snaps the past two seasons with two different injuries, which is definitely something to look out for. His combine testing was extremely disappointing and could drop him off some NFL big boards immediately. His 4.9 RAS is suspect, and few corners have ever succeeded with his 4.6 (35%) forty yard dash. Ricks

is an unusual prospect with limited film on him this season. He'll struggle against the elite athletes in the NFL, and shouldn't get drafted to be a press/off man cornerback. Ricks has a reasonably high floor due to his physicality and instincts. He'll start as a CB₃/rotational corner and can be a solid starter in zone coverage.

Strengths:

Length

Ball Skills

Physical Hand Usage

Route Instincts

Weaknesses:

Hip Fluidity

Long Speed

Can Overcommit To Routes

Coverage Reps/Injuries

Grade: Late Third

14. Tre'vius Hodges-Tomlinson (#92)

TCU – (5'8" 178 lbs)

The nephew of Ladanian Tomlinson, Tre Hodges-Tomlinson is as physical as corners get. Tre is a complete outlier at only 5'8" 178 lbs with 29" arms. His tiny frame is a liability against bigger receivers and he overcompensates with extreme physicality that is both good and bad. He's fluid with track speed and breaks on routes extremely well. Tre makes impressive plays on the ball, leading college football with 21 forced incompletions this season. His demeanor leads to Tre overcommit on some routes and grabbing too frequently, which will get him penalized in the NFL. A corner of his size needs elite testing numbers, and Tre did just that. He ran a 4.41 40 (90%), 39" vert (90%), and 11' broad (97%). His score is weighed down by his 1st percentile size and dropped him to a 7.95 RAS.

Tre'vius has the mentality, athletic traits and cornerback talent to be a successful boundary NFL corner. His size is a massive limiting factor that will practically pigeonhole him into the slot, unless guarding especially small receivers on

Table Of Contents

the outside. Few corners have survived at his size, but Tre has everything else going for him. He'll get called for penalties early as a rational slot his rookie season. Tre'vius can become a viable slot option.

Strengths:

Fluid/Movement Skills

Ball Skills

Tight Coverage

Motor/Effort

College Production

Weaknesses:

Tiny Frame

Handsy/Penalties

Can Overcommit To Routes

Grade: Late Third

15. Tyrique Stevenson (#98)

Miami – (6'0" 198 lbs)

Following two disappointing seasons at Georgia, Tyrique Stevenson transferred to Miami as their boundary corner. Stevenson is long with 33" arms that he uses often to break up passes and press wide receivers. Press man is Stevenson's best corner role and his length is his biggest advantage. He plays with an attacking mentality and non stop high intensity. Tyrique puts effort into the run game where he can make plays. He has good eyes that go along with solid ball skills.

Stevenson isn't a natural mover, and his change of direction is clunky. His hip fluidity can be a problem and leads to him losing ground on fakes and double moves. Tyrique Stevenson's long speed isn't elite either, he isn't the shutdown corner to put on the NFL's speed demons. When Stevenson can get his hands on the receiver and affect the play at the start he's much more comfortable and successful. His movement skills in open space is an issue, and Stevenson brings little value as an off-man

cornerback. In a press man scheme, Tyrique can be a rotational/backup corner as a rookie who can develop into a nickel/rotational start with added run defense.

Strengths:

Length/Press Coverage

Ball Skills

Tackling

Physicality

Weaknesses:

Fluidity

Flat Footed

Scheme Specific

Grade: Early Fourth

16. Garrett Williams (#99)

Syracuse – (5'10" 192 lbs)

Garrett Williams was a notable prospect who was mocked in the top fifty this season before tearing his ACL and playing only seven games. He's missed every part of the draft process and will likely miss at least the start of his rookie season. Williams is a fluid mover with agile footwork. He thrives in zone coverage with the instinct to hold an area. Williams mirrors well and is an adequate tackler. He has the burst and acceleration to defend outside, but isn't a special athlete. Williams has average long speed and can get deep. His ball skills are below average, with him failing to turn back to the ball. Bigger receivers were a problem for Williams at the catch point, especially in his poor outing against Purdue. It's even harder to project him athletically when we don't know how he'll look after he recovers from the injury. Williams is a big unknown at the position, without the elite traits to justify the bet in early rounds. If fully healthy, Williams can be a solid zone corner, who will be a steal in the later rounds.

Strengths:

Zone Instincts

Burst

Table Of Contents

Footwork

Weaknesses:

Long Speed

Deep Balls

Bigger Receivers

ACL Tear

Grade: Fourth

Safety



Safeties are a tough position to scout and it's extremely difficult to find proper film for many of the top prospects. I heavily focus on a Safety's reaction time and how well he can digest routes and attack them. Their instincts are key to succeeding as rookies and Safeties will get targeted early on if they fail to react quickly. Quality single high safeties are rare in the draft and it'll be tough to find one in this class. A majority of these prospects play a LB/SS role where they play in the box, defend underneath routes and guard Tight Ends. It's tough to fit prospects into a scheme when they lack a defined role.

1. Brian Branch (#23)

Alabama – (6'0" 190 lbs)

Brian Branch has been often named as the most "pro ready" secondary prospect. He captained Alabama's defense and earned high praise from his teammates. Branch is an excellent tackler with only a 3% missed tackle rate (9th in CFB). He's a

Table Of Contents

stellar zone defender with an uncoachable football IQ. Branch is fluid enough to play man and was Alabama's slot corner for a majority of his snaps. He is effective as a run defender with smart angles and a quick reaction time.

Branch is highly skilled, but isn't a high end athlete. He doesn't have elite speed and can get burnt deep. Branch's frame is also a concern and he should attempt to pack on muscle. He's too thin to be utilized as a power blitzer, and his change of direction in man coverage needs refining. His testing was average as expected, capping his ceiling right below the superstar safeties. Branch is a super versatile chess piece, capable of being an impactful run defender who makes plays in the backfield, while also starting as a slot/box defender. He's less useful in man and has better instincts and movements as a zone defender. His frame and long speed won't go unnoticed, but Branch will immediately slide into a starting high floor role and can be a valuable Pro Bowl defender.

Strengths:

Chess Piece Versatility

Zone Coverage

Footwork

Run Defense

Weaknesses:

Lean Frame

Elite Speed

Strictly Slot Corner- Won't Play Boundary

Fighting Through Blocks

Grade: Late First

2. JL Skinner (#35)

Boise St. – (6'4" 209 lbs)

While not my top ranked safety, JL Skinner is my favorite prospect at the position. He's incredibly long and lanky at 6'4" 209 lbs, with long 32" arms that create a disruptive radius. Skinner lives for contact, attacking the ball on every play with big hit

ability. He's a quick reactor with elite speed that wraps up ball carriers. Skinner has the length to guard tight ends. Skinner was one of the most exciting safeties in college football and brings instant playmaking to the NFL.

His length comes with disadvantages, especially Skinner's lateral stiffness. He lacks the fluidity to cover receivers consistently, and is much better guarding underneath routes. Skinner has tons of untapped growth in his frame and can afford to add some mass to his slender build. Skinner was invited to the Senior Bowl, but tore his pec and missed the entire pre-draft process. Defenses are scheming up new ways to guard tight ends and Skinner's blend of length and speed makes him the perfect fit. He'll cover TE's while also affecting the run game as a downhill force. Skinner is a day one starter at low SS or Box safety, with the traits and motor to bet on. While he's not a traditional single high or man defender, Skinner has a high ceiling in all of his roles.

Strengths:

Great Length

Elite Speed

Box Ability

Physical Tackling

Weaknesses:

Lateral Stiffness

Single High Safety

Man Coverage Vs Receivers

Thin Frame

Grade: Early/Mid Second

3. Christopher Smith (#50)

Georgia – (5'10" 192 lbs)

If you're looking for a deep safety pick on day two, Christopher Smith is the ideal addition. He's a leaner prospect that can be filled out, but is an extremely instinctual defender. Chris Smith reads and reacts to plays quickly and can track the ball well. His coverage skills overall are pretty solid and can start as a rookie. Smith isn't insanely fluid, but has the movement skills to play nickel corner as well. His film

Table Of Contents

against Kentucky was lackluster, but his opening day performance against Oregon was elite.

Chris Smith can burst out of his stance, but isn't a downhill force. His bigger concern is his hesitation to tackle, and can sometimes be too passive when attacking the ball. While he wasn't billed as an elite athlete, his combine performance was concerning, and may plummet his stock come draft day. Chris Smith came in smaller than expected and none of his numbers were impressive whatsoever. Scoring a 2.75 RAS (27%), Smith lacks the explosive ability that teams often look for. Chris Smith is a smart chess piece safety, with the football IQ to survive at multiple different roles. His limited length and pure athleticism limit his ceiling, but Smith's zone skills lend him a decent floor. He's not a downhill power presence, but can affect sideline runs. Smith's a rookie starter, preferably as a deep safety or nickel defender, that will have the usual rookie struggles but can develop into a solid versatility safety. He needs to put on mass to increase his ceiling as a player.

Strengths:

Football IQ

COD

Versatility

Coverage Instincts

Weaknesses:

Frame

Downhill Force

Sometimes Is Passive

Combine Performance

Grade: Mid/Late Second

+ Sydney Brown (#60)

Illinois – (5'10" 211 lbs)

Sydney Brown is an exciting safety prospect on the rise. He's a condensed 5'10" with a low center of gravity. Brown fits the modern S/LB hybrid as a playmaker on the second level. He's a quick reactor with instincts and ball skills. Most of his limitations

Table Of Contents

stem from his size, as he'll have trouble navigating through NFL lineman. Brown has man-to-man experience and is a good candidate to guard smaller tight ends. His combine was explosive, with a 4.47 40 (93%), 40.5 vert (97%), 10'10 broad (97%) and 9.66 RAS. Brown is a workout warrior that has maximized his frame. His tackling radius and overall size is hard to overlook, but Brown has a role to play in the NFL. With players like Talanoa Hufanga playing the "playmaking LB/SS" role, Brown has the range and instincts to fit right in.

Strengths:

Reactions/Instincts

Ball Skills

Playmaker

Athleticism/Combine

Versatility

Weaknesses:

Size/Length

Can Get Moved

Misses Some Backfield Tackles

Grade: Late Second/Early Third

5. Antonio Johnson (#72)

Texas A&M – (6'2" 198 lbs)

Antonio Johnson is a tough eval as a talented player who doesn't easily slide into a role. Texas A&M started him in the linebacker role, using him as a "find the ball" box safety. Johnson is a good tackler who has the range to make plays on the line. He also played a ton of underneath zone coverage and guarded tight ends. He's decently fluid and guarded players as a slot corner. There were occasional snaps where Johnson was lined up as a true deep safety. Johnson reacts to the ball well and is a downhill force, but can over aggressively commit to plays. He doesn't play a valuable NFL role, and isn't athletic enough to be a true swiss army knife. His 31' jump (13%) and 9'10 broad (44%) rounded out a disappointing 5.25 RAS. Johnson has many talents and is best used as a slot corner/ballfinder. As the NFL is constantly evolving, there's a chance that a

defensive minded coach finds a role that suits Johnson perfectly. He'll play special defensive package reps as a rookie and has the skills to grow into a true box/slot safety role.

Strengths:

Tackling

Attacking The Ball

Versatility

Weaknesses:

True NFL Role

Man Coverage

Single High

Grade: Early Third

6. Jordan Battle (#73)

Alabama – (6'1" 209 lbs)

While Alabama had a disappointing season, Jordan Battle established himself as a key component of their defense. Battle played the single high safety role and ran a ton of zone coverage. He's fluid and has solid overall movement skills. Battle's instincts are sharp and he'll find receivers in zone. He has a good build and length for a safety. He's more proven than most other prospects as a deep zone safety, and he'll slide into a team's defensive scheme.

Jordan Battle has decent athleticism, but he's an overly rangy safety that will make plays all over the field. He's passive in the run game and lacks the downhill force to be a true impact player. His run game angles need work as well and he missed a handful of tackles this season. Battle's been tested defensively, but he's mostly a one dimensional zone safety. His run defense will have teams wanting more, but he's one of the higher floor safety prospects in the class. Battle can hold up in an NFL defense as a deep free safety.

Strengths:

Table Of Contents

Zone Instincts
COD
Frame
Zone Experience

Weaknesses:

Tackling
Downhill Aggression
Run Game

Grade: Early Third

7. Jammie Robinson (#94)

Florida St. – (5'10" 192 lbs)

Jammie Robinson was Florida State's do it all safety. He's small for the position, but is a fluid mover. He reacts quickly to the ball with his impressive instincts and finds the ball. Jammie's composure and ball carrier tracking helps him excel in run defense. Most current safeties are rangy defenders who make plays on the ball all over the field, Jammie lacks elite speed and isn't the high impact pass defender that other safeties are. His length does him no favors with only 29½" arms. He profiles best as a box/ss that can affect the run game. Jammie isn't quite the athlete or coverage back to play FS or nickel. He'll start out as a rotational safety who can work his way up.

Strengths:

Instincts
Run Defense
Reactions

Weaknesses:

Frame
Man Coverage
Range/Elite Speed

Grade: Late Third/Early Fourth

8. Ji'ayir Brown (#109)

Penn State – (5'11" 203 lbs)

Ji'ayir Brown is an exciting safety whose draft stock took an unfortunate tumble at the combine. Brown played both in the box and deep safety for Penn State as a rangy, explosive defender. He has an attacking mentality and gives full effort to find the ball. Brown has downhill speed and the power to blitz and fight through blocks. He's an A+ energy and effort defender that coaches will love. Brown can get over excited and overcommit to plays. He isn't a fluid ball tracker and can run blind looking to make a hit. Brown has poor coverage technique and will not play a single high role in the NFL. He is far from a coverage safety and will most likely be a box defender.

With the majority of Ji'ayir Brown's value coming from his explosiveness and range, his combine was extremely disappointing. He ran a slow 4.65 forty yard dash (36%) and jumped only 32.5" in the vertical (27%). Brown's 5.95 RAS diminishes his profile as an athletic, traitsy prospect. Without his athleticism, Brown doesn't fit a true role. He'll be a productive special teams player and can earn reps as a box safety. Brown will likely fall in the draft, and you're betting that his tape will outweigh his combine testing.

Strengths:

Motor/Effort
Downhill Force
Finds The Ball

Weaknesses:

Combine Testing
Can Overcommit
Coverage Technique

Grade: Fourth

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Until Next Year- Mister Irrelevant

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